



SAPIENZA
UNIVERSITÀ DI ROMA

Mathematical Analysis 1

Volume 5 — Series

The fifth volume: series. Numerical series, series with non-negative terms and convergence tests, series with terms of variable sign, series of functions. Definitions, theorems with proofs and worked examples; at the end, the exercises on series with solutions and, in the appendix, the exercises on antiderivatives and integrals.

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Online version and downloadable material:
fabiofurini.github.io/mathematical-analysis-1/
github.com/fabiofurini/mathematical-analysis-1

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Numerical series

1.1 Numerical series

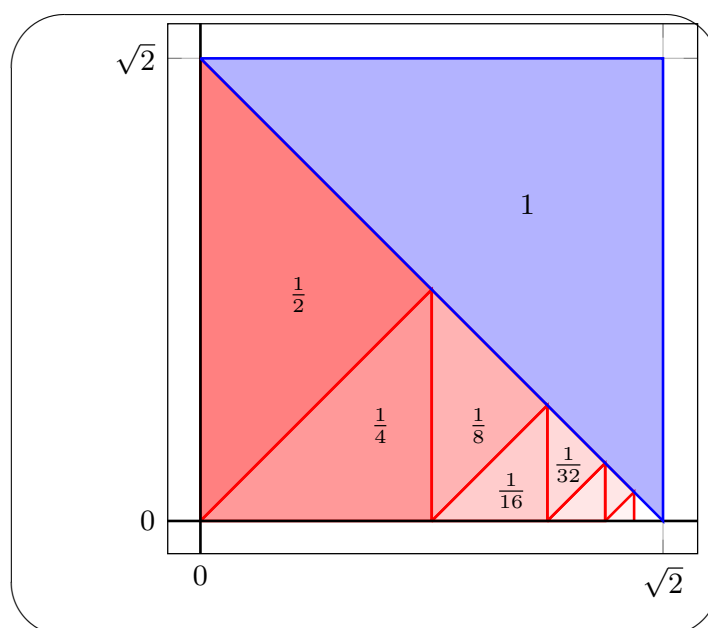
- We now introduce numerical series, which extend the operation of addition to an infinite number of terms.

The sum of infinitely many terms, even if they are all positive, can give a finite result.

- Imagine measuring a square of area 2 using the following procedure: we divide the square in half along the diagonal and measure the first right triangle: we obtain 1; then we divide the second right triangle in half and measure the first of the two resulting right triangles: we obtain $\frac{1}{2}$; the remaining right triangle is again divided in half... and so on indefinitely. We obtain the infinite sum:

$$1 + \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4} + \frac{1}{8} + \frac{1}{16} + \frac{1}{32} + \dots + \frac{1}{2^k} + \dots = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{2^k}$$

which, by the way it was constructed, must give 2 as its result.



Definition 1.1: of numerical series

Given a sequence $\{a_k\}_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$, we call **numerical series** of the terms a_k the expression:

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k$$

- It is read “series (or also sum) for k from 0 to $+\infty$ of a_k ”. The values a_k are called the **general terms of the series**.

Definition 1.2: of sequence of partial sums

The numbers

$$s_n = \sum_{k=0}^n a_k = a_0 + a_1 + \dots + a_n, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}$$

are called the **n -th partial sums** of the series and they define **the sequence $\{s_n\}$ of partial sums**.

The **behavior (character) of the series** is determined by the limit of the sequence $\{s_n\}$ as n tends to infinity. We say that a series is **convergent**, **divergent**, **irregular**, if the sequence $\{s_n\}$ of partial sums is **convergent**, **divergent** or **irregular**, respectively.

Definition 1.3: of sum of the series

If the sequence $\{s_n\}$ of partial sums is **convergent**, that is, if

$$s_n \rightarrow s \in \mathbb{R} \quad \text{as} \quad n \rightarrow +\infty$$

we say that s is **the sum of the series**, and we write $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k = s$.

Hence, if the sequence $\{s_n\}$ is **convergent**, we have:

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \sum_{k=0}^n a_k = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} s_n = s$$

The series makes precise the idea of a sum of infinitely many terms, that is, we compute the limit as $n \rightarrow +\infty$ of the finite sum of the first n terms.

- If, instead of summing starting from 0, we start from an index $n_0 > 0$, we write $\sum_{k=n_0}^{\infty} a_k$
- To denote a generic numerical series without specifying the starting index n_0 we will use the symbol $\sum a_k$

A generic numerical series $\sum a_k$ always involves **two different sequences**:

1. the sequence $\{a_k\}$ of the **terms of the series**
2. the sequence $\{s_n\}$ of **partial sums**

Example 1.1: behavior of a series

Let us determine the behavior of the series:

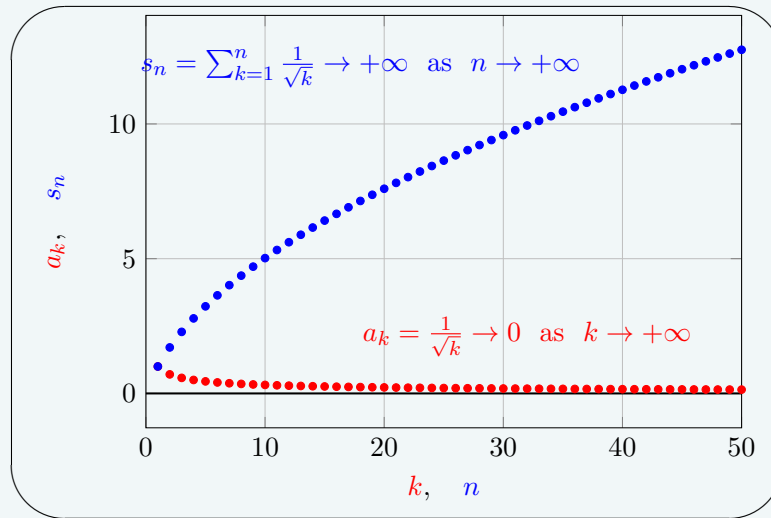
$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{\sqrt{k}}$$

We have:

$$s_n = \sum_{k=1}^n \frac{1}{\sqrt{k}} = 1 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + \dots + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n}} \geq n \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{n}} = \sqrt{n} \rightarrow +\infty \quad \text{as } n \rightarrow +\infty$$

n terms, each $\geq \frac{1}{\sqrt{n}}$

Hence the sequence of partial sums $\{s_n\}$ is divergent by the comparison theorem for sequences and, consequently, the series is divergent.



1.1.1 Main properties of numerical series

Observation 1.4

If a sequence $\{a_k\}$ has non-negative terms, that is, $a_k \geq 0, \forall k$, then the sequence of partial sums $\{s_n\}$ is increasing and regular.

Proof. Given a sequence $\{a_k\}$ with non-negative terms, the sequence of partial sums $\{s_n\}$ is increasing since:

$$s_{n+1} = s_n + \underbrace{a_{n+1}}_{\geq 0} \geq s_n, \quad \forall n, \quad \text{hence} \quad \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} s_n = \sup_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \{s_n\}$$

by the monotonicity theorem for sequences. Consequently the sequence $\{s_n\}$ cannot be irregular. It is therefore regular, that is, it either converges or diverges. $\square$

Given a sequence $\{a_k\}$ with non-negative terms:

- If $\{s_n\}$ is **increasing and bounded**, then it has a finite limit and $\sum a_k$ converges.
- If $\{s_n\}$ is **increasing and unbounded**, then $\sum a_k$ diverges to $+\infty$.

- This remark also holds for sequences with eventually non-negative terms, positive terms, or eventually positive terms.

Theorem 1.5

If a series $\sum a_k$ is convergent, then $\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} a_k = 0$

Proof. By definition of convergent series, the sequence of partial sums $\{s_n\}$ converges to a real number s , i.e., $s_n \rightarrow s \in \mathbb{R}$ as $n \rightarrow +\infty$. Without loss of generality we consider $n_0 = 0$.

We observe that the sequence $\{s_n\}$ can be defined recursively:

$$s_0 = a_0, \quad s_n = s_{n-1} + a_n, \quad \forall n \geq 1$$

Consequently we have:

$$a_n = s_n - s_{n-1} \quad \text{and hence} \quad \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} a_n = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} (s_n - s_{n-1}) = s - s = 0$$

$\square$

The convergence of a series therefore implies that $a_k \rightarrow 0$ as $k \rightarrow +\infty$, that is:

$$\sum a_k \text{ convergent} \quad \Rightarrow \quad \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} a_k = 0 \quad (1.1)$$

but the converse is not true (Example 1 is a counterexample):

$$\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} a_k = 0 \quad \nRightarrow \quad \sum a_k \text{ convergent} \quad (1.2)$$

Hence the fact that $a_k \rightarrow 0$ as $k \rightarrow +\infty$ is a necessary but not sufficient condition for the convergence of a series.

- From the contrapositive of (1.1) we have:

$$\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} a_k \neq 0 \Rightarrow \sum a_k \text{ is divergent or irregular}$$

that is, if the limit is not equal to zero, then the series is not convergent.

1.1.2 Tails of series

If we modify a finite number of terms of a series, the value of the sum may change, but the behavior of the series remains unchanged.

- If we modify the value of one term, for example a_{n_0} , for $n \geq n_0$ the sequences of partial sums, the original and the modified one, differ only by that term: hence both converge, both diverge, or both are irregular. The same holds if we modify a finite number of terms.

The results on the behavior of series therefore also hold if the hypotheses are satisfied “eventually”, i.e., from a certain index n_0 onward.

Definition 1.6: of tail of a series

Given a series $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k$ and a value $m \in \mathbb{N}$, the series $\sum_{k=m+1}^{\infty} a_k$ is called a **tail of the series**.

- Given a series $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k$ and $m \in \mathbb{N}$ we have:

$$\sum_{k=m+1}^n a_k = \left(\sum_{k=0}^n a_k \right) - \left(\sum_{k=0}^m a_k \right) = s_n - s_m, \quad \forall n > m \quad (1.3)$$

hence for every tail (that is, for every m) the associated sequence of partial sums is equal to that of the original series minus a constant. Consequently we have the following remark:

Every tail of a series has the same behavior as the original series.

- Given a convergent series, taking the limit as $n \rightarrow +\infty$ in (1.3) we obtain the relation:

$$\sum_{k=m+1}^{\infty} a_k = \left(\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k \right) - \left(\sum_{k=0}^m a_k \right) = s - s_m \quad \text{as } n \rightarrow +\infty \quad (1.4)$$

Consequently we have the following remark:

Given $m \in \mathbb{N}$, every tail $\sum_{k=m+1}^{\infty} a_k$ of a convergent series can be interpreted as the **error** that we make when approximating the sum s with the partial sum s_m .

Theorem 1.7

If a series $\sum a_k$ is convergent, then

$$\underbrace{s - s_m}_{\sum_{k=m+1}^{\infty} a_k} \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } m \rightarrow +\infty$$

Proof. For every $n > m$, the n -th partial sum of the series is:

$$s_n = s_m + \sum_{k=m+1}^n a_k$$

Taking the limit as $n \rightarrow +\infty$, we have:

$$\begin{aligned} s &= s_m + \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \sum_{k=m+1}^n a_k \\ &= \sum_{k=m+1}^{\infty} a_k \end{aligned}$$

Now taking the limit as $m \rightarrow +\infty$, we have:

$$s = s + \lim_{m \rightarrow +\infty} \sum_{k=m+1}^{\infty} a_k \Rightarrow \lim_{m \rightarrow +\infty} \sum_{k=m+1}^{\infty} a_k = 0$$

that is, the claim of the theorem. □

This theorem tells us that, if a series is convergent, then the value $s - s_m$, that is, the error that we make when approximating the sum s with the partial sum s_m , tends to zero as $m \rightarrow +\infty$. In other words, the tail of a convergent series tends to zero as m tends to infinity.

1.1.3 Harmonic series

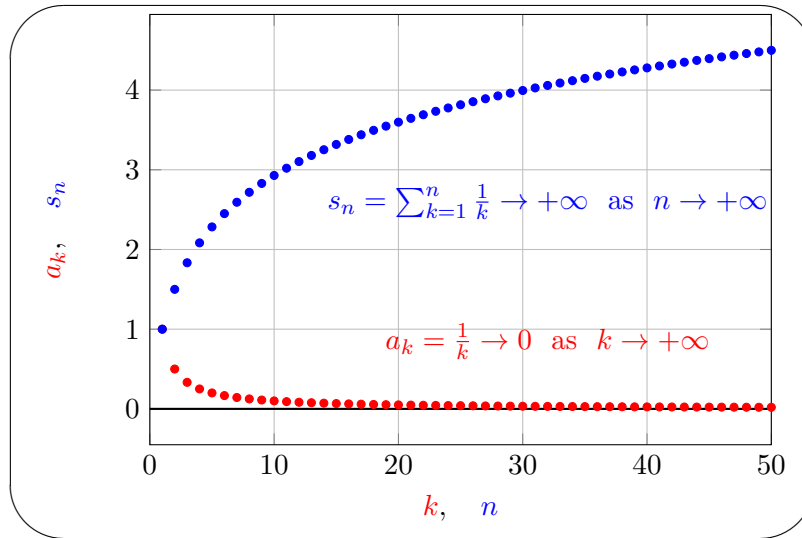
Definition 1.8: of harmonic series

The **harmonic series** is the series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k}$

Theorem 1.9: behavior of the harmonic series

The harmonic series diverges to $+\infty$

- Graphically we have:



The harmonic series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k}$ is a counterexample that proves (1.2), since:

$$\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{1}{k} = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \text{ diverges to } +\infty$$

- Before proving the theorem, we observe that for certain values of n the partial sums are:

$$\begin{aligned} \underbrace{s_1}_{=s_{2^0}} &= 1 + \frac{0}{2}, & \underbrace{s_2}_{=s_{2^1}} &= s_1 + \frac{1}{2} = 1 + \frac{0}{2} + \frac{1}{2} = 1 + \frac{1}{2}, \\ \underbrace{s_4}_{=s_{2^2}} &= s_2 + \underbrace{\left(\frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{4}\right)}_{\geq \frac{1}{4} + \frac{1}{4} = \frac{1}{2}} \geq 1 + \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2} = 1 + \frac{2}{2} \\ \underbrace{s_8}_{=s_{2^3}} &= s_4 + \underbrace{\left(\frac{1}{5} + \frac{1}{6} + \frac{1}{7} + \frac{1}{8}\right)}_{\geq \frac{1}{8} + \frac{1}{8} + \frac{1}{8} + \frac{1}{8} = \frac{1}{2}} \geq 1 + \frac{2}{2} + \frac{1}{2} = 1 + \frac{3}{2} \\ \underbrace{s_{16}}_{=s_{2^4}} &= s_8 + \underbrace{\left(\frac{1}{9} + \frac{1}{10} + \frac{1}{11} + \frac{1}{12} + \frac{1}{13} + \frac{1}{14} + \frac{1}{15} + \frac{1}{16}\right)}_{\geq \frac{1}{16} + \frac{1}{16} + \frac{1}{16} + \frac{1}{16} + \frac{1}{16} + \frac{1}{16} + \frac{1}{16} + \frac{1}{16} = \frac{1}{2}} \geq 1 + \frac{3}{2} + \frac{1}{2} = 1 + \frac{4}{2} \end{aligned}$$

Proof. We prove by induction on 2^n that

$$s_{2^n} \geq 1 + \frac{n}{2}, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}$$

Base case. Let $n = 0$. Then the statement becomes $s_{2^0} \geq 1 + \frac{0}{2}$, i.e., $1 \geq 1$, which is clearly true.

Inductive step. Assume that it is true for 2^{n-1} and let us prove it for 2^n . By the inductive hypothesis, we have:

$$s_{2^{n-1}} \geq 1 + \frac{n-1}{2}$$

Moreover, we have:

$$\begin{aligned} s_{2^n} &= s_{2^{n-1}} + \underbrace{\sum_{k=2^{n-1}+1}^{2^n} \left(\frac{1}{k}\right)}_{\geq 2^{n-1} \cdot \frac{1}{2^n} = \frac{1}{2}} \quad \text{hence} \quad s_{2^n} \geq 1 + \frac{n-1}{2} + \frac{1}{2} = 1 + \frac{n}{2} \\ &\geq 2^{n-1} \cdot \frac{1}{2^n} = \frac{1}{2} \end{aligned}$$

which is exactly the desired statement for 2^n .

We therefore have:

$$s_{2^n} \geq 1 + \frac{n}{2} \rightarrow +\infty \quad \text{as} \quad n \rightarrow +\infty$$

and $\{s_n\}$ is unbounded above and also monotonically increasing, since $a_k = 1/k > 0, \forall k > 1$. Consequently $\{s_n\}$ diverges to $+\infty$ by the monotonicity theorem for sequences, and the harmonic series diverges to $+\infty$. □

The sequence $a_k = 1/k, \forall k \geq 1$, of the harmonic series has positive terms, hence the sequence of partial sums $\{s_n\}$ is increasing, and it is divergent since it is unbounded.

1.1.4 Geometric series

Definition 1.10: of geometric series

Given $q \in \mathbb{R}$, the **geometric series** with **ratio** q is the series $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} q^k$

Theorem 1.11: behavior and sum of the geometric series

Given the ratio $q \in \mathbb{R}$,

$$\text{the geometric series } \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} q^k \quad \text{is} \quad \begin{cases} \text{convergent} & \text{if } |q| < 1 \\ \text{divergent to } +\infty & \text{if } q \geq 1 \\ \text{irregular} & \text{if } q \leq -1 \end{cases}$$

If the geometric series is convergent, its sum s is $\frac{1}{1-q}$

Proof. Given $q \in \mathbb{R}$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$, the n -th partial sum of the geometric series is:

$$\sum_{k=0}^n q^k = \begin{cases} \frac{1 - q^{n+1}}{1 - q} & \text{if } q \neq 1 \\ n + 1 & \text{if } q = 1 \end{cases}$$

since it equals the sum of the first $n + 1$ terms of the geometric progression. Moreover, we have:

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} q^n = \begin{cases} +\infty & \text{if } q > 1 \\ 1 & \text{if } q = 1 \\ 0 & \text{if } |q| < 1 \\ \text{does not exist} & \text{if } q \leq -1 \end{cases}$$

Hence, if $q \neq 1$:

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} s_n = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{1 - q^{n+1}}{1 - q} = \frac{1}{1 - q} \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} (1 - q^{n+1}) = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{1 - q} & \text{if } |q| < 1 \\ +\infty & \text{if } q > 1 \\ \text{does not exist} & \text{if } q \leq -1 \end{cases}$$

and if $q = 1$ we have:

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} s_n = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} (n + 1) = +\infty$$

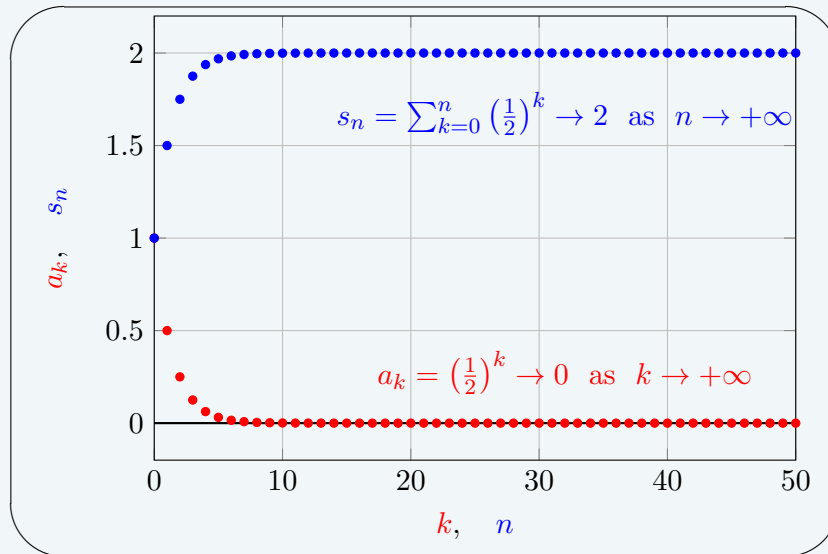
□

Example 1.2: geometric series

Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{2^k} = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^k$$

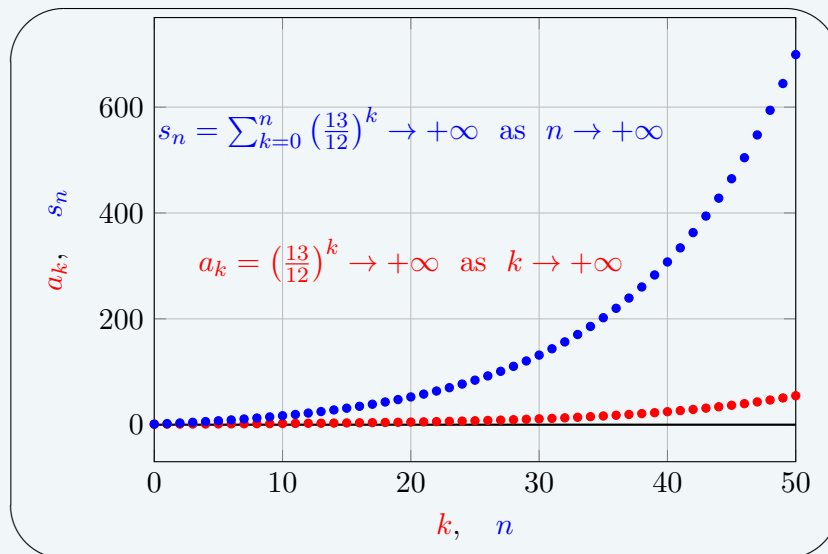
It is a geometric series with ratio $q = 1/2$, hence it is convergent and its sum s is $1/(1 - 1/2) = 2$.



Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \left(\frac{13}{12}\right)^k$$

It is a geometric series with ratio $q = 13/12$, hence it is divergent.



1.1.5 Telescoping series

Definition 1.12: of telescoping series

A **telescoping series** is a series of the form:

$$\sum_{k=n_0}^{\infty} (b_k - b_{k+1}) \quad \text{where } \{b_k\} \text{ is a sequence}$$

Theorem 1.13: behavior and sum of the telescoping series

A telescoping series converges, diverges or is irregular according to whether the sequence $\{b_k\}$ converges, diverges or is irregular, respectively.

$$\text{If } \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} b_k = \ell \in \mathbb{R}^* \quad \text{then} \quad \sum_{k=n_0}^{\infty} (b_k - b_{k+1}) = b_{n_0} - \underbrace{\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} b_k}_{=\ell \in \mathbb{R}^*}$$

Moreover, if $\ell \in \mathbb{R}$, then the telescoping series is convergent and its sum s is $b_{n_0} - \ell$

Proof. We have

$$\begin{aligned} s_n &= \sum_{k=n_0}^{n_0+n} (b_k - b_{k+1}) \\ &= (b_{n_0} - b_{n_0+1}) + (b_{n_0+1} - b_{n_0+2}) + \dots + (b_{n_0+n} - b_{n_0+n+1}) \\ &= b_{n_0} - b_{n_0+n+1} \end{aligned}$$

hence:

$$\sum_{k=n_0}^{\infty} (b_k - b_{k+1}) = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} s_n = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} (b_{n_0} - b_{n_0+n+1}) = b_{n_0} - \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} b_n$$

□

Observation 1.14

The series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k(k+1)}$, called **Mengoli's series**, is convergent and its sum s is equal to 1.

Proof. We have:

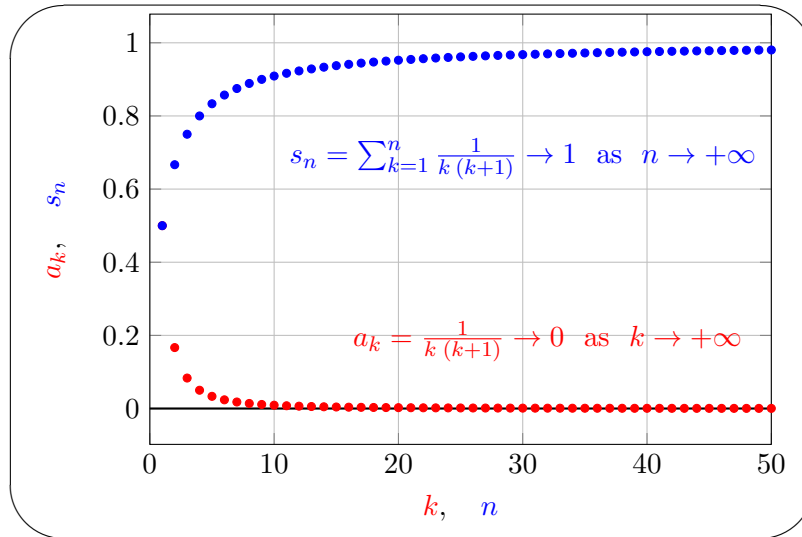
$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k(k+1)} = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{(k+1) - k}{k(k+1)} = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \underbrace{\frac{1}{k}}_{=b_k} - \underbrace{\frac{1}{k+1}}_{=b_{k+1}}$$

Mengoli's series therefore has the form:

$$b_k - b_{k+1} \quad \text{with} \quad b_k = \frac{1}{k} \quad \text{and moreover} \quad \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} b_k = \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{1}{k} = 0$$

hence it is a convergent telescoping series ($n_0 = 1$) and moreover $s = b_1 = 1$. $\square$

- Graphically we have:



Proof. **Alternative proof**

For every $n \geq 1$, the value of the partial sum of Mengoli's series is:

$$\begin{aligned} s_n &= \sum_{k=1}^n \frac{1}{k(k+1)} = \sum_{k=1}^n \left(\frac{1}{k} - \frac{1}{k+1} \right) \\ &= \left(1 - \frac{1}{2} \right) + \left(\frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{3} \right) + \dots + \left(\frac{1}{n} - \frac{1}{n+1} \right) = 1 - \frac{1}{n+1} \end{aligned}$$

Hence we have

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} a_k = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} s_n = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} 1 - \frac{1}{n+1} = 1$$

Consequently Mengoli's series is convergent and its sum s is 1. $\square$

Example 1.3: telescoping series

Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{(3k+2)(3k+5)}$$

We have:

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{1}{(3k+2)(3k+5)} &= \frac{\alpha}{3k+2} - \frac{\beta}{3k+5} = \frac{\alpha(3k+5) - \beta(3k+2)}{(3k+2)(3k+5)} \\ &= \frac{3(\alpha - \beta)k + 5\alpha - 2\beta}{(3k+2)(3k+5)} \\ \Rightarrow \begin{cases} 3(\alpha - \beta) = 0 \\ 5\alpha - 2\beta = 1 \end{cases} &\Rightarrow \alpha = \beta, \quad 3\alpha = 1 \quad \text{hence} \quad \alpha = \beta = \frac{1}{3}\end{aligned}$$

consequently:

$$\frac{1}{(3k+2)(3k+5)} = \frac{1}{3} \left(\frac{1}{3k+2} - \frac{1}{3k+5} \right) = \frac{1}{3} \left(\underbrace{\frac{1}{3k+2}}_{=b_k} - \underbrace{\frac{1}{3(k+1)+2}}_{=b_{k+1}} \right)$$

The series therefore has the form:

$$b_k - b_{k+1} \quad \text{with} \quad b_k = \frac{1}{3k+2} \quad \text{and moreover} \quad \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} b_k = \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{1}{3k+2} = 0$$

that is, a telescoping series ($n_0 = 1$), and we have:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{(3k+2)(3k+5)} = \frac{1}{3} \left(b_1 - \underbrace{\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} b_k}_{\rightarrow 0} \right) = \frac{1}{3} b_1 = \frac{1}{15}$$

Hence it is a convergent telescoping series and its sum s is $\frac{1}{15}$.

Series with non-negative terms

2.1 Series with non-negative terms

A series $\sum a_k$ with non-negative terms (or positive terms) is **regular**, that is, it is either convergent or divergent to $+\infty$ (it cannot be irregular, as we have proved). Such a series converges if and only if the sequence of its partial sums is bounded.

2.1.1 Comparison test

Theorem 2.1: Comparison test

Let $\{a_k\}$ and $\{b_k\}$ be two sequences with non-negative terms such that $a_k \leq b_k$ eventually; then:

$$\begin{aligned} i) \quad \sum b_k \text{ convergent} &\Rightarrow \sum a_k \text{ convergent} \\ ii) \quad \sum a_k \text{ divergent} &\Rightarrow \sum b_k \text{ divergent} \end{aligned}$$

- The series $\sum b_k$ is called the **dominating series** (majorant), while the series $\sum a_k$ is called the **dominated series** (minorant).

Proof. Since $a_k \leq b_k$ eventually, there exists $m \in \mathbb{N}$ such that:

$$a_k \leq b_k, \quad \forall k \geq m$$

Let us now consider the n -th partial sums of the tails of the two sequences $\{a_k\}$ and $\{b_k\}$, with $n > m$:

$$s_n^a = \sum_{k=m+1}^n a_k \quad \text{and} \quad s_n^b = \sum_{k=m+1}^n b_k$$

Since $0 \leq a_k \leq b_k$, $\forall k \geq m$, we have

$$0 \leq s_n^a \leq s_n^b, \quad \forall n \geq m \quad (2.1)$$

The sequences $\{s_n^a\}$ and $\{s_n^b\}$ are regular, since $\{a_k\}$ and $\{b_k\}$ have non-negative terms.

Hence the claims *i)* and *ii)* are logically equivalent, so it suffices to prove the second one.

Saying that $\sum a_n$ is divergent means, by the definition of divergent series, that $s_n \rightarrow +\infty$ as $n \rightarrow +\infty$. Moreover, since every tail has the same behavior as the original series, we have $s_n^a \rightarrow +\infty$ as $n \rightarrow +\infty$.

From (2.1), by the comparison theorem for sequences, also $s_n^b \rightarrow +\infty$ as $n \rightarrow +\infty$. Hence the tail of $\{b_k\}$ is divergent and consequently $\sum b_n$ is divergent. $\square$

Observation 2.2

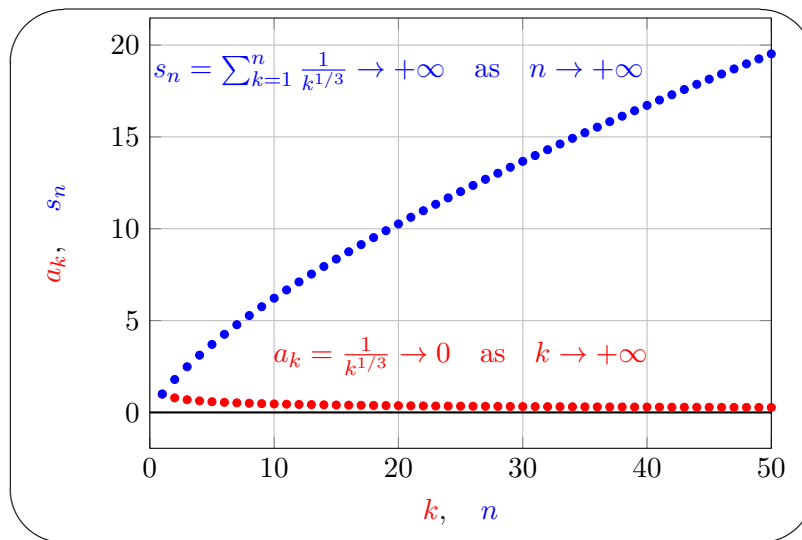
Given $\alpha \leq 1$, the series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k^\alpha}$ is divergent to $+\infty$.

Proof. With $\alpha = 1$ we have the harmonic series, which diverges to $+\infty$. With $\alpha < 1$, the series dominates the harmonic series, since:

$$\frac{1}{k} \leq \frac{1}{k^\alpha}, \quad \forall k \in \mathbb{N}, k \geq 1 \quad \text{and} \quad \alpha < 1$$

hence $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k^\alpha}$ is divergent by the comparison test. $\square$

- Graphically, for example with $\alpha = \frac{1}{3}$, we have:



2.1.2 Limit comparison test

Theorem 2.3: Limit comparison test

Let $\{a_k\}$ and $\{b_k\}$ be two sequences with positive terms. If the sequences are asymptotically equivalent, that is, if:

$$a_k \sim b_k \quad \text{as } k \rightarrow +\infty$$

then the corresponding series $\sum a_k$ and $\sum b_k$ are regular and have the same behavior, i.e., either they are both convergent or they are both divergent.

Proof. The series $\sum a_k$ and $\sum b_k$ are regular because the sequences $\{a_k\}$ and $\{b_k\}$ have positive terms. Since $a_k \sim b_k$ as $k \rightarrow +\infty$, we have:

$$\frac{a_k}{b_k} \rightarrow 1 \quad \text{as } k \rightarrow +\infty$$

Hence, for every $\varepsilon > 0$, there exists $m \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\forall k \geq m$ we have:

$$1 - \varepsilon < \frac{a_k}{b_k} < 1 + \varepsilon \quad \text{and hence} \quad (1 - \varepsilon) b_k < a_k < (1 + \varepsilon) b_k \quad \text{since } b_k > 0, \forall k$$

We have thus proved that $(1 - \varepsilon) b_k < a_k < (1 + \varepsilon) b_k$ eventually. Hence, by the comparison test, the series $\sum a_k$ and $\sum b_k$ have the same behavior.

The first of the two inequalities implies that if $\sum a_k$ is convergent then $\sum b_k$ is also convergent, while the second one implies that if $\sum a_k$ is divergent then $\sum b_k$ is also divergent. □

Observation 2.4

Given $\alpha \geq 2$, the series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k^\alpha}$ is convergent.

Proof. With $\alpha = 2$ we have:

$$\frac{1}{k^2} \sim \frac{1}{k(k+1)} \quad \text{as } k \rightarrow +\infty$$

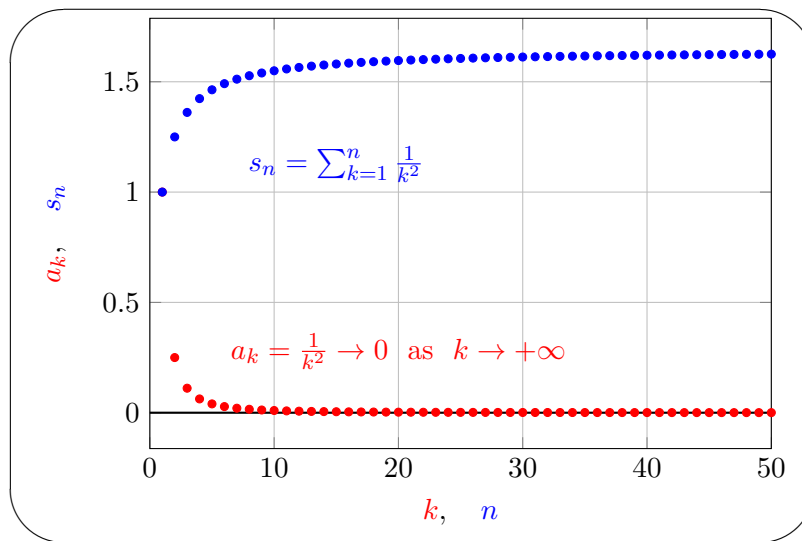
and the series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k(k+1)}$ converges (Mengoli's series). Hence, by the limit comparison test, $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k^2}$ also converges.

With $\alpha > 2$, the series is dominated by the series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k^2}$, since:

$$\frac{1}{k^\alpha} \leq \frac{1}{k^2}, \quad \forall k \in \mathbb{N}, k \geq 1 \quad \text{and} \quad \alpha > 2$$

hence $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k^\alpha}$ is convergent by the comparison test. □

- Graphically, for example with $\alpha = 2$, we have:



Example 2.1: limit comparison test

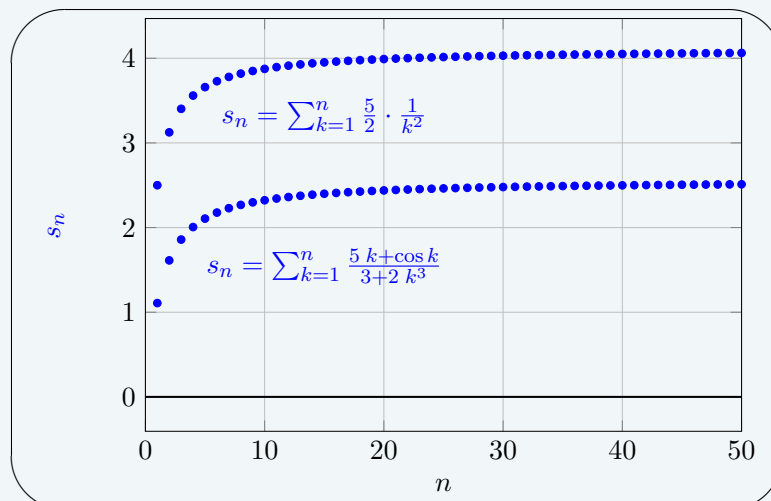
Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{5k + \cos k}{3 + 2k^3}$$

We have:

$$\frac{5k + \cos k}{3 + 2k^3} \sim \frac{5}{2} \cdot \frac{1}{k^2} \quad \text{as } k \rightarrow +\infty \quad \text{and} \quad \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{5}{2} \cdot \frac{1}{k^2} \quad \text{converges}$$

hence the series is convergent by the limit comparison test.



However, even if the sequences are asymptotically equivalent, the corresponding series may not have the same sum.

2.1.3 Condensation test

Theorem 2.5: Condensation test

If $\{a_k\}$ is an eventually decreasing sequence with non-negative terms, then the series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} a_k$ and $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 2^k a_{2^k}$ are regular and have the same behavior, i.e., either they are both convergent or they are both divergent.

- Before proving the theorem, let us consider the sequence $\{\tilde{s}_n\}$ of the partial sums of the sequence $\{2^k a_{2^k}\}$, that is, the sequence:

$$\tilde{s}_n = \sum_{k=0}^n 2^k a_{2^k} \quad \forall n \geq 0$$

and let us derive two important relations with the sequence $\{s_n\}$ of the partial sums of the sequence $\{a_k\}$, that is, the sequence:

$$s_n = \sum_{k=1}^n a_k \quad \forall n \geq 1$$

- We observe that, for certain values of n , the partial sums s_n are:

$$\begin{aligned} \underbrace{s_1}_{=s_{2^1-1}} &= a_1, & \underbrace{s_3}_{=s_{2^2-1}} &= s_1 + a_2 + \underbrace{a_3}_{\leq a_2} \leq a_1 + 2 a_2 \\ \underbrace{s_7}_{=s_{2^3-1}} &= s_3 + a_4 + \underbrace{a_5}_{\leq a_4} + \underbrace{a_6}_{\leq a_4} + \underbrace{a_7}_{\leq a_4} \leq a_1 + 2 a_2 + 4 a_4 \\ \underbrace{s_{15}}_{=s_{2^4-1}} &= s_7 + a_8 + \underbrace{a_9}_{\leq a_8} + \underbrace{a_{10}}_{\leq a_8} + \underbrace{a_{11}}_{\leq a_8} \\ &\quad + \underbrace{a_{12}}_{\leq a_8} + \underbrace{a_{13}}_{\leq a_8} + \underbrace{a_{14}}_{\leq a_8} + \underbrace{a_{15}}_{\leq a_8} \leq a_1 + 2 a_2 + 4 a_4 + 8 a_8 \end{aligned}$$

Observation 2.6

Given an eventually decreasing sequence $\{a_k\}$ with non-negative terms, we have:

$$s_{2^n-1} \leq \underbrace{\sum_{k=0}^{n-1} 2^k a_{2^k}}_{=\tilde{s}_{n-1}} \quad \forall n \geq 1 \quad (2.2)$$

Proof. We prove by induction on 2^n that

$$s_{2^n-1} \leq \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} 2^k a_{2^k} \quad \forall n \geq 1$$

Base case. Let $n = 1$. Then the claim becomes $s_{2^1-1} \leq 2^0 a_1$, i.e., $a_1 \leq a_1$, which is clearly true.

Inductive step. Assume that it is true for 2^{n-1} and let us prove it for 2^n . By the inductive hypothesis, we have $s_{2^{n-1}-1} \leq \sum_{k=0}^{n-2} 2^k a_{2^k}$. Moreover, we have:

$$s_{2^n-1} = s_{2^{n-1}-1} + \underbrace{\sum_{i=2^{n-1}}^{2^n-1} a_i}_{\leq 2^{n-1} a_{2^{n-1}}} \quad \text{hence} \quad s_{2^n-1} \leq \sum_{k=0}^{n-2} 2^k a_{2^k} + 2^{n-1} a_{2^{n-1}} = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} 2^k a_{2^k}$$

which is exactly the desired claim for 2^n . □

- We now observe that the values of $\tilde{s}_n$ are:

$$\tilde{s}_0 = a_1 \leq 2 a_1 = 2 \underbrace{s_1}_{= s_{2^0}}, \quad \tilde{s}_1 = \tilde{s}_0 + 2 a_2 \leq 2 s_1 + 2 a_2 = 2 \underbrace{s_2}_{= s_{2^1}}$$

$$\tilde{s}_2 = \tilde{s}_1 + 4 a_4 \leq 2 s_2 + 2 a_3 + 2 a_4 = 2 \underbrace{s_4}_{= s_{2^2}} \quad (\text{since } a_4 \leq a_3)$$

$$\tilde{s}_3 = \tilde{s}_2 + 8 a_8 \leq 2 s_4 + 2 a_5 + 2 a_6 + 2 a_7 + 2 a_8 = 2 \underbrace{s_8}_{= s_{2^3}} \quad (\text{since } a_8 \leq a_7 \leq a_6 \leq a_5)$$

Observation 2.7

Given an eventually decreasing sequence $\{a_k\}$ with non-negative terms, we have:

$$\underbrace{\sum_{k=0}^n 2^k a_{2^k}}_{= \tilde{s}_n} \leq 2 s_{2^n} \quad \forall n \geq 0 \quad (2.3)$$

Proof. We prove by induction on 2^n that

$$\tilde{s}_n \leq 2 s_{2^n} \quad \forall n \geq 0$$

Base case. Let $n = 0$. Then the claim becomes $\tilde{s}_0 \leq 2 s_{2^0} = 2 s_1$, i.e., $a_1 \leq 2 a_1$, which is clearly true.

Inductive step. Assume that it is true for $n - 1$ and let us prove it for n . By the

inductive hypothesis, we have $\tilde{s}_{n-1} \leq 2 s_{2^{n-1}}$. Moreover, we have:

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{s}_n &= \tilde{s}_{n-1} + \underbrace{2^n a_{2^n}}_{2^n} \quad \text{hence} \quad \tilde{s}_n \leq 2 s_{2^{n-1}} + \sum_{i=2^{n-1}+1}^{2^n} 2 a_i = 2 s_{2^n} \\ &\leq \sum_{i=2^{n-1}+1}^{2^n} 2 a_i \end{aligned}$$

which is exactly the desired claim for n . $\square$

- We are now able to prove the theorem.

Proof. From relation (2.2) we have:

$$s_{2^n-1} \leq \tilde{s}_{n-1}, \quad \forall n \geq 1$$

Hence, if $\{\tilde{s}_n\}$ is convergent, that is, if $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 2^k a_{2^k}$ is convergent, the subsequence $\{s_{2^n-1}\}$ is bounded. Since $\{s_n\}$ is monotone, the whole sequence $\{s_n\}$ is bounded and convergent by the monotone sequence theorem. Consequently, if $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 2^k a_{2^k}$ is convergent, then $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} a_k$ is also convergent.

From relation (2.3) we have:

$$\tilde{s}_n \leq 2 s_{2^n}, \quad \forall n \geq 0$$

Hence, if $\{s_n\}$ is convergent, that is, if $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} a_k$ is convergent, then the subsequence $\{s_{2^n}\}$ is convergent (since $\{s_n\}$ is monotone). Consequently, by comparison, $\{\tilde{s}_n\}$ is also convergent, that is, $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 2^k a_{2^k}$ converges.

Moreover, since $\{a_k\}$ has non-negative terms, the series cannot be irregular; consequently, we also have:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} a_k \text{ divergent} \iff \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 2^k a_{2^k} \text{ divergent}$$

which completes the proof of the theorem. $\square$

Given an eventually decreasing sequence $\{a_k\}$ with non-negative terms, we have proved that:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} a_k \text{ convergent/divergent} \iff \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 2^k a_{2^k} \text{ convergent/divergent}$$

Hence the convergence/divergence of $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 2^k a_{2^k}$ is a necessary and sufficient condition for the convergence/divergence of $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} a_k$.

2.1.4 Generalized harmonic series

Definition 2.8: Generalized harmonic series

Given $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$, the series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k^\alpha}$ is called the **generalized harmonic series**

Theorem 2.9: Behavior of the generalized harmonic series

Given $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$,

the generalized harmonic series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k^\alpha}$ is $\begin{cases} \text{divergent to } +\infty & \text{if } \alpha \leq 1 \\ \text{convergent} & \text{if } \alpha > 1 \end{cases}$

Proof. We have already established that it diverges for $\alpha \leq 1$. For $\alpha > 1$, the sequence $\{\frac{1}{k^\alpha}\}$ is a decreasing sequence with positive terms. We have:

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 2^k a_{2^k} = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} 2^k \frac{1}{(2^k)^\alpha} = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (2^{1-\alpha})^k$$

that is, a geometric series with ratio $2^{1-\alpha}$, which converges if and only if $2^{1-\alpha} < 1$, that is, if $1 - \alpha < 0$. Hence, for $\alpha > 1$, by the condensation test, the series converges. $\square$

2.1.5 Passing from the discrete to the continuous

- The tools used to establish asymptotic estimates of functions can also be used to obtain asymptotic estimates of sequences (**passing from the discrete to the continuous**), and they provide useful tools for studying the behavior of a series with positive terms.

Example 2.2: passing from the discrete to the continuous

Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{e^{1/k} - 1}{k}$$

From the asymptotic equivalence

$$e^{\varepsilon(x)} - 1 \sim \varepsilon(x) \quad \text{as} \quad \varepsilon(x) \rightarrow 0$$

we have

$$\frac{e^{1/k} - 1}{k} \sim \frac{1}{k^2} \quad \text{as} \quad k \rightarrow +\infty$$

Therefore the series, which has positive terms, converges by limit comparison with the series of $1/k^2$.

Example 2.3: passing from the discrete to the continuous

Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \log \left(\frac{k+3}{k+2} \right)$$

We have

$$\frac{k+3}{k+2} = 1 + \frac{1}{k+2} = 1 + \frac{1}{k+2}$$

From the asymptotic equivalence

$$\log(1 + \varepsilon(x)) \sim \varepsilon(x) \quad \text{as} \quad \varepsilon(x) \rightarrow 0$$

we have

$$\log \left(1 + \frac{1}{k+2} \right) \sim \frac{1}{k+2} \sim \frac{1}{k} \quad \text{as} \quad k \rightarrow +\infty$$

Thus it is a series with positive terms whose general term is asymptotically equivalent to $1/k$. By comparison with the harmonic series, this series diverges to $+\infty$.

Example 2.4: passing from the discrete to the continuous

Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \left(\frac{1}{k} - \sin \frac{1}{k} \right)$$

From the third-order Maclaurin expansion

$$\sin(\varepsilon(x)) = \varepsilon(x) - \frac{(\varepsilon(x))^3}{3!} + o\left((\varepsilon(x))^3\right) \quad \text{as} \quad \varepsilon(x) \rightarrow 0$$

we have

$$\frac{1}{k} - \sin \frac{1}{k} = \frac{1}{k} - \left(\frac{1}{k} - \frac{1}{6k^3} + o\left(\frac{1}{k^3}\right) \right) \sim \frac{1}{6k^3} \quad \text{as} \quad k \rightarrow +\infty$$

Therefore the series, which has positive terms, converges by limit comparison with the series of $1/(6k^3)$.

2.1.6 Root test
Theorem 2.10: Root test

Let $\{a_k\}$ be a sequence with non-negative terms. If the following limit exists:

$$\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \sqrt[k]{a_k} = \ell \in \mathbb{R}^*$$

then the series $\sum a_k$ is $\begin{cases} \text{convergent} & \text{if } \ell < 1 \text{ or } \ell = -\infty \\ \text{divergent to } +\infty & \text{if } \ell > 1 \text{ or } \ell = +\infty \end{cases}$

Proof. Suppose that $\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \sqrt[k]{a_k} = \ell < 1$. Since $\sqrt[k]{a_k} \rightarrow \ell \in \mathbb{R}$, for every $\varepsilon > 0$ there exists $m \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\forall k \geq m$:

$$\sqrt[k]{a_k} \leq \ell + \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$$

Moreover, since $\ell < 1$, we have $\ell < 1 - \varepsilon$ for a suitable $\varepsilon > 0$. For this ε we therefore have, eventually:

$$\sqrt[k]{a_k} \leq \ell + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} < (1 - \varepsilon) + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} = 1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2} \quad \text{hence} \quad a_k < \left(1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)^k, \quad \forall k \geq m$$

We have thus proved that $a_k < \left(1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)^k$ eventually. The geometric series:

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)^k \quad \text{is convergent since} \quad 1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2} < 1$$

Hence, by the comparison test, the original series converges.

Suppose that $\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \sqrt[k]{a_k} = \ell > 1$. Since $\sqrt[k]{a_k} \rightarrow \ell \in \mathbb{R}$, for every $\varepsilon > 0$ there exists $m \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\forall k \geq m$:

$$\sqrt[k]{a_k} \geq \ell - \frac{\varepsilon}{2}$$

Moreover, since $\ell > 1$, we have $\ell > 1 + \varepsilon$ for a suitable $\varepsilon > 0$. For this ε we therefore have, eventually:

$$\sqrt[k]{a_k} \geq \ell - \frac{\varepsilon}{2} > (1 + \varepsilon) - \frac{\varepsilon}{2} = 1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} \quad \text{hence} \quad a_k > \left(1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)^k, \quad \forall k \geq m$$

We have thus proved that $a_k > \left(1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)^k$ eventually. The geometric series:

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \left(1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)^k \quad \text{is divergent since} \quad 1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} > 1$$

Hence, by the comparison test, the original series diverges.

□

Clearly, these arguments remain valid also if $\ell = -\infty$ or $+\infty$, respectively.

Observation 2.11

The series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} k^{\beta} \cdot b^k$ with $\beta \in \mathbb{R}, b \geq 0$ is

{	convergent if $b < 1$ divergent if $b > 1$ convergent if $b = 1$ and $\beta < -1$ divergent if $b = 1$ and $\beta \geq -1$
---	---

Proof. It is a series with non-negative terms, and we have:

$$\sqrt[k]{k^\beta \cdot b^k} = b \cdot k^{\beta/k} \quad \text{and} \quad \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} k^{\beta/k} = \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \exp \left(\underbrace{\frac{\beta}{k} \cdot \log k}_{\rightarrow 0} \right) = 1$$

hence, by the root test, it converges for $b < 1$ and diverges for $b > 1$. If $b = 1$, the series becomes:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} k^\beta = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k^{-\beta}}$$

that is, a generalized harmonic series; it is convergent for $\beta < -1$, while it is divergent for $\beta \geq -1$. $\square$

Observation 2.12

The series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} b^k/k^k$ with $b \geq 0$ is convergent

Proof. It is a series with non-negative terms, and we have:

$$\sqrt[k]{\frac{b^k}{k^k}} = \frac{b}{k} \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as} \quad k \rightarrow +\infty$$

hence the series converges by the root test. $\square$

2.1.7 Ratio test

Theorem 2.13: Ratio test

Let $\{a_k\}$ be a sequence with positive terms. If the following limit exists:

$$\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{a_{k+1}}{a_k} = \ell \in \mathbb{R}^*$$

then the series $\sum a_k$ is $\begin{cases} \text{convergent} & \text{if } \ell < 1 \text{ or } \ell = -\infty \\ \text{divergent to } +\infty & \text{if } \ell > 1 \text{ or } \ell = +\infty \end{cases}$

Proof. Suppose that $\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} a_{k+1}/a_k = \ell < 1$. Reasoning as in the proof of the root test, there exists $m \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\forall k \geq m$:

$$\frac{a_{k+1}}{a_k} < \left(1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)$$

for a suitable $\varepsilon > 0$. Reasoning iteratively, this implies that:

$$a_{k+1} < \left(1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right) a_k < \left(1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right) \left(1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right) a_{k-1} < \dots < \left(1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)^{k-m+1} a_m$$

We have thus proved that $a_k < \left(1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)^{k-m} a_m$ eventually. The geometric series:

$$\sum_{k=m}^{\infty} \left(1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)^{k-m} a_m \text{ is convergent since } 1 - \frac{\varepsilon}{2} < 1$$

Hence, by the comparison test, the original series converges.

Suppose that $\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} a_{k+1}/a_k = \ell > 1$. Reasoning as in the proof of the root test, there exists $m \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\forall k \geq m$:

$$\frac{a_{k+1}}{a_k} > \left(1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)$$

for a suitable $\varepsilon > 0$. Reasoning iteratively, this implies that:

$$a_{k+1} > \left(1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right) a_k > \left(1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right) \left(1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right) a_{k-1} > \dots > \left(1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)^{k-m+1} a_m$$

We have thus proved that $a_k > \left(1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)^{k-m} a_m$ eventually. The geometric series:

$$\sum_{k=m}^{\infty} \left(1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2}\right)^{k-m} a_m \text{ is divergent since } 1 + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} > 1$$

Hence, by the comparison test, the original series diverges. □

Clearly, these arguments remain valid also if $\ell = -\infty$ or $+\infty$, respectively.

Observation 2.14

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k!} = e$$

Proof. We have

$$\frac{1/(k+1)!}{1/k!} = \frac{1}{k+1} \rightarrow 0 \text{ as } k \rightarrow +\infty$$

Therefore the series, which has non-negative terms, converges by the ratio test. The proof that the sum of the series is equal to e will be given later using series of functions. □

2.1.8 Series with non-positive terms

- We know that the behavior of a series does not change if we alter a finite number of its terms. Consequently, the tests for series with non-negative terms also apply to series whose terms are eventually non-negative.
- Moreover, by factoring a minus sign out of the whole series, we see that these tests can also be applied to series with non-positive terms, and hence to series whose terms are eventually non-positive.

In summary, therefore, the tests we have seen apply to series all of whose terms (except for a finite number) have the same sign.

Series with terms of variable sign

3.1 Series with terms of variable sign

Definition 3.1: absolutely convergent series

A series $\sum a_k$ is absolutely convergent if the series $\sum |a_k|$ converges.

Theorem 3.2

If a series $\sum a_k$ converges absolutely, then it converges.

Proof. Without loss of generality, let $n_0 = 0$ and consider the following series:

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (|a_k| - a_k)$$

It is a series with nonnegative terms since, for every $k \in \mathbb{N}$, we have:

$$\begin{cases} |a_k| - a_k = -2a_k \geq 0 & \text{if } a_k < 0 \\ |a_k| - a_k = 0 & \text{if } a_k \geq 0 \end{cases}$$

Moreover, by the triangle inequality, for every $k \in \mathbb{N}$, we have:

$$\underbrace{|a_k| - a_k}_{\geq 0} = ||a_k| - a_k| \leq |a_k| + |a_k| = 2|a_k|$$

Hence, by the comparison test for series with nonnegative terms, we have

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} |a_k| \text{ convergent} \implies \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (|a_k| - a_k) \text{ convergent}$$

Since for every $k \in \mathbb{N}$ we have $a_k = |a_k| - (|a_k| - a_k)$ and the series $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} |a_k|$ and $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (|a_k| - a_k)$ converge, we have:

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} |a_k| - \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (|a_k| - a_k)$$

that is, the series is the difference of two convergent series. Consequently, the series $\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} a_k$ is convergent as well. $\square$

- The following is an alternative proof.

Proof. Without loss of generality, let $n_0 = 0$ and split the sequence $\{s_n\}$ of partial sums into two sequences, the first containing only the positive terms and the second only the negative terms:

$$s_n^+ = \sum_{k \in \{0,1,\dots,n\}: a_k > 0} a_k \quad \text{and} \quad s_n^- = \sum_{k \in \{0,1,\dots,n\}: a_k < 0} -a_k \quad \text{hence} \quad s_n = s_n^+ - s_n^-$$

Consequently, it is enough to show that the sequences $\{s_n^+\}$ and $\{s_n^-\}$ are convergent to conclude that $\{s_n\}$ converges, and hence that the series $\sum a_k$ converges.

We observe that $\{s_n^+\}$ and $\{s_n^-\}$ are monotone non-decreasing sequences and moreover, by the triangle inequality, we have:

$$s_n^+ \leq \sum_{k=0}^n |a_k| \quad \text{and} \quad s_n^- \leq \sum_{k=0}^n |a_k|$$

On the other hand, by hypothesis the series $\sum a_k$ converges absolutely, i.e., $\sum |a_k|$ converges, and hence the quantity $\sum_{k=0}^n |a_k|$ is bounded; therefore the sequences $\{s_n^+\}$ and $\{s_n^-\}$ are bounded above and non-decreasing, and hence they converge, by the monotone sequence theorem. $\square$

Example 3.1: absolute convergence

Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{k^\alpha} \quad \text{with} \quad \alpha > 1$$

We have:

$$\left| \frac{(-1)^k}{k^\alpha} \right| = \frac{1}{k^\alpha}, \quad \forall k \in \mathbb{N}, k > 1 \quad \text{and} \quad \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k^\alpha} \quad \text{is convergent for} \quad \alpha > 1$$

Therefore the series converges absolutely and hence it converges.

Absolute convergence implies ordinary convergence, also called simple convergence:

$$\sum |a_k| \text{ convergent} \quad \Rightarrow \quad \sum a_k \text{ convergent} \quad (3.1)$$

but the converse is not true (we will give a counterexample later):

$$\sum a_k \text{ convergent} \quad \nRightarrow \quad \sum |a_k| \text{ convergent} \quad (3.2)$$

Hence absolute convergence is a sufficient but not necessary condition for ordinary convergence.

3.1.1 Alternating series and the Leibniz test

- Among series with terms of variable sign, a particularly simple case is given by alternating series, for which the following convergence test holds.

Theorem 3.3: Leibniz (alternating series) test

Consider the series

$$\sum_{k=n_0}^{\infty} (-1)^k a_k \quad \text{with} \quad a_k \geq 0, \forall k$$

If the sequence $\{a_k\}$ is decreasing and $a_k \rightarrow 0$ as $k \rightarrow +\infty$, then the series is convergent. Moreover:

$$s_{2n} = \sum_{k=n_0}^{2n} (-1)^k a_k \downarrow s \quad \text{and} \quad s_{2n+1} = \sum_{k=n_0}^{2n+1} (-1)^k a_k \uparrow s \quad \text{as } n \rightarrow +\infty$$

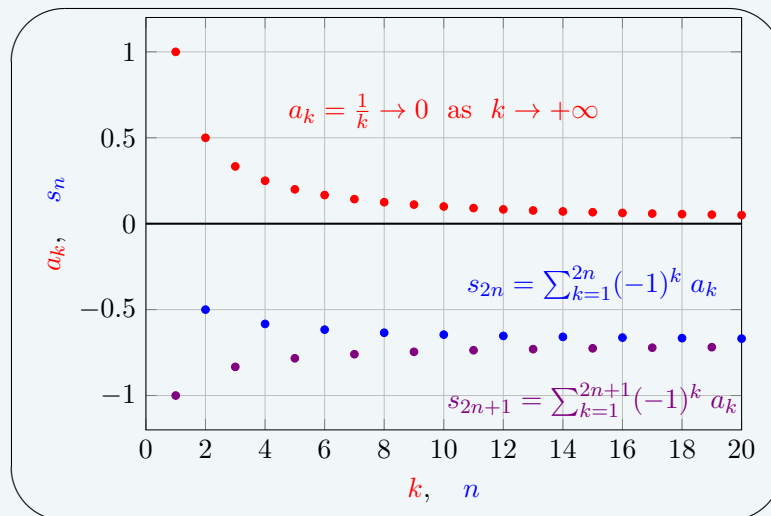
- The partial sums with even index approximate the sum s from above and those with odd index from below.
- The Leibniz test can clearly be applied also if the terms eventually have alternating signs and the sequence $\{a_k\}$ is eventually decreasing.

Example 3.2: Leibniz test

Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} (-1)^k \frac{1}{k}$$

The sequence $a_k = \frac{1}{k}$ is decreasing and non-negative. Moreover $\frac{1}{k} \rightarrow 0$ as $k \rightarrow +\infty$, hence it satisfies the two conditions of the Leibniz test theorem. Consequently, the series is convergent.



The series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{k}$ converges and is a counterexample to (3.2), that is, a series that converges but does not converge absolutely, since:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \left| \frac{(-1)^k}{k} \right| = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \quad \text{and} \quad \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \text{ diverges (harmonic series)}$$

Proof. Consider the sequence of partial sums $\{s_n\}$ with $n_0 = 0$ and the two subsequences extracted from it, $\{s_{2n}\}$ and $\{s_{2n+1}\}$.

For $\{s_{2n}\}$ we have:

$$s_0 = a_0, \quad s_2 = s_0 - a_1 + \underbrace{a_2}_{\leq a_1} \leq s_0, \quad s_4 = s_2 - a_3 + \underbrace{a_4}_{\leq a_3} \leq s_2, \quad \dots$$

hence the sequence $\{s_{2n}\}$ is monotone decreasing.

For $\{s_{2n+1}\}$ we have:

$$s_1 = a_0 - a_1, \quad s_3 = s_1 + a_2 - \underbrace{a_3}_{\leq a_2} \geq s_1, \quad s_5 = s_3 + a_4 - \underbrace{a_5}_{\leq a_4} \geq s_3, \quad \dots$$

hence the sequence $\{s_{2n+1}\}$ is monotone increasing.

Moreover, we have:

$$s_1 \leq s_{2n+1} = s_{2n} - a_{2n+1} \leq s_{2n} \leq s_0$$

therefore $\{s_{2n+1}\}$ is bounded above and $\{s_{2n}\}$ is bounded below. The two sequences are hence convergent, by the monotone sequence theorem.

The two sequences converge to the same limit, because

$$0 \leq s_{2n} - s_{2n+1} \leq a_{2n+1} \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as} \quad n \rightarrow +\infty$$

Calling s this limit, since $\{s_{2n}\}$ is monotone decreasing and $\{s_{2n+1}\}$ is monotone increasing, we have:

$$s_{2n} = \sum_{k=n_0}^{2n} (-1)^k a_k \downarrow s \quad \text{and} \quad s_{2n+1} = \sum_{k=n_0}^{2n+1} (-1)^k a_k \uparrow s \quad \text{as} \quad n \rightarrow +\infty$$

Hence the series is convergent since $s_{2n+1} \rightarrow s$ and $s_{2n} \rightarrow s$ as $n \rightarrow +\infty$, and consequently we have:

$$s_n \rightarrow s \quad \text{as} \quad n \rightarrow +\infty$$

□

Corollary 3.4: of the Leibniz test theorem

Given a series satisfying the hypotheses of the Leibniz test theorem, we have:

$$\begin{aligned} |s - s_m| &\leq a_{m+1}, \quad \forall m \in \mathbb{N} \\ &= \left| \sum_{k=m+1}^{\infty} (-1)^k a_k \right| \end{aligned}$$

- For every m , the error made by approximating s with s_m is, in absolute value, bounded above by the value of the first omitted term. In other words, the tail of the series tends to a value less than or equal to a_{m+1} .

Proof. Since

$$s_{2n+1} \uparrow s \quad \text{and} \quad s_{2n} \downarrow s \quad \text{as } n \rightarrow +\infty$$

we therefore have, for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$:

$$s_{2n-1} \leq s \leq s_{2n} \quad \text{and} \quad s_{2n+1} \leq s \leq s_{2n}$$

from which we deduce

$$0 \leq s - s_{2n-1} \leq s_{2n} - s_{2n-1} = a_{2n} \quad \text{and} \quad 0 \leq s_{2n} - s \leq s_{2n} - s_{2n+1} = a_{2n+1}$$

Therefore, for every m , whether even or odd, we have:

$$|s - s_m| = \left| \sum_{k=m+1}^{\infty} (-1)^k a_k \right| \leq a_{m+1}$$

□

Example 3.3: Leibniz test

Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} (-1)^k \frac{k-1}{k^2+k}$$

We have:

$$a_k = \frac{k-1}{k^2+k} = \frac{k-1}{k(k+1)} \geq 0, \forall k \in \mathbb{N}, k \geq 1 \quad \text{and} \quad \frac{k-1}{k(k+1)} \sim \frac{1}{k} \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } k \rightarrow +\infty$$

hence the series does not converge absolutely. However, the series is decreasing for $k \geq 2$ since:

$$\underbrace{\frac{k}{(k+1)(k+2)}}_{=a_{k+1}} \leq \underbrace{\frac{k-1}{k(k+1)}}_{=a_k} \iff k^2 \leq k^2 + k - 2 \iff k \geq 2$$

hence the series converges by the Leibniz test, since it is eventually decreasing.

Example 3.4: Leibniz test

Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=2}^{\infty} (-1)^k \frac{\log k}{k}$$

We have:

$$a_k = \frac{\log k}{k} \geq 0, \forall k \geq 2 \quad \text{and} \quad \frac{\log k}{k} \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } k \rightarrow +\infty$$

moreover

$$\frac{\log k}{k} > \frac{1}{k} \quad \text{for } k \geq 3 \quad \text{and} \quad \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k} \quad \text{diverges}$$

hence the series does not converge absolutely. Proving algebraically that the sequence $\{a_k\}$ is decreasing is complicated; instead, we pass from the discrete to the continuous setting. We have, for $x \in \mathbb{R}$ and $x \geq 2$:

$$f(x) = \frac{\log x}{x} \quad \text{and} \quad f'(x) = \frac{1 - \log x}{x^2} \leq 0 \quad \text{for } x \geq e$$

It follows that f is decreasing for $x \geq e$; consequently the sequence $a_k = f(k)$ is decreasing for $k \geq 3$ (the first integer $> e$). Hence the series converges by the Leibniz test.

if $\sum a_k$ converges and $\sum b_k$ converges then $\sum (a_k + b_k)$ converges

if $\sum a_k$ converges and $\sum b_k$ diverges then $\sum (a_k + b_k)$ diverges

This can be checked by viewing the series as the limit of the sequence of partial sums and applying the theorem on the limit of a sum.

Example 3.5: Leibniz test

Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{k+1 + (-1)^k k^2}{k^3}$$

We split it into the sum of two series:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{k+1 + (-1)^k k^2}{k^3} = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{k+1}{k^3} + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{k}$$

For the first series we have:

$$\frac{k+1}{k^3} \geq 0, \forall k \geq 1 \quad \text{and} \quad \frac{k+1}{k^3} \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } k \rightarrow +\infty$$

hence it converges by the limit comparison test, since:

$$\frac{k+1}{k^3} \sim \frac{1}{k^2} \quad \text{and} \quad \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k^2} \quad \text{converges}$$

The second series converges by the Leibniz test; hence the original series converges.

Example 3.6: Leibniz test

Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} (-1)^k \left(\frac{\sqrt{k} + (-1)^k}{k} \right)$$

We split it into the sum of two series:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} (-1)^k \left(\frac{\sqrt{k} + (-1)^k}{k} \right) = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^k}{\sqrt{k}} + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k}$$

The first series converges by the Leibniz test; the second diverges (harmonic series); hence the original series diverges.

Example 3.7: Leibniz test

Let us determine the behavior of the series:

$$\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^{k+1}}{k}$$

We have:

$$\frac{(-1)^{k+1}}{k} = -\frac{(-1)^k}{k}, \quad \forall k \in \mathbb{N}, k > 1$$

moreover, the sequence $a_k = \frac{1}{k}$ is decreasing and $\frac{1}{k} \rightarrow 0$ as $k \rightarrow +\infty$, hence it satisfies the two conditions of the theorem. Consequently, the series $\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^{k+1}}{k}$ converges.

Series of functions

4.1 Series of functions

- **Series of functions** are numerical series depending on a parameter x : when these series converge for every value x belonging to a certain interval, they represent **functions of a new kind**
- There are two important classes of series of functions, namely trigonometric series and power series. We will only deal with **power series**, also called **Taylor series**, which can be seen as a natural extension of Taylor expansions.

4.1.1 Taylor series of the elementary transcendental functions

- Taylor's expansion/formula with Lagrange remainder can be rewritten in the form:

$$f(x) = \sum_{k=0}^n \frac{f^{(k)}(x_0)}{k!} (x - x_0)^k + E_n(x) \quad (4.1)$$

where the Lagrange approximation error is

$$E_n(x) = \frac{f^{(n+1)}(c)}{(n+1)!} (x - x_0)^{n+1} \quad (4.2)$$

and c is a suitable point between x_0 and x .

Definition 4.1: Taylor series

If a function f has derivatives of every order, the series

$$\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{f^{(k)}(x_0)}{k!} (x - x_0)^k$$

is called the **Taylor series** of the function f centered at x_0 .

At a given point $x \in (a, b)$, if the error

$$E_n(x) \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as} \quad n \rightarrow +\infty$$

then the Taylor series is convergent and its sum equals $f(x)$. This is equivalent to saying

that the n -th partial sum of the series has a finite limit and this limit is precisely $f(x)$. In formulas:

$$\underbrace{T_{n,x_0}(x)}_{\text{Taylor polynomial}} = \sum_{k=0}^n \frac{f^{(k)}(x_0)}{k!} (x - x_0)^k \rightarrow f(x) \quad \text{as } n \rightarrow +\infty$$

Definition 4.2: function expandable in Taylor series on an interval

Given a function $f : D \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ with derivatives of every order, if

$$E_n(x) \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } n \rightarrow +\infty, \quad \forall x \in I \subseteq D$$

we say that $f(x)$ is **expandable in Taylor series** on the interval I .

- There are (infinitely differentiable) functions that are expandable in Taylor series on the whole real line, others that are expandable only on a bounded interval, and others for which the interval reduces to a single point (the point x_0).
- We now deal with the three elementary transcendental functions:

$$f(x) = e^x, \quad f(x) = \sin x \quad \text{and} \quad f(x) = \cos x$$

which we will show to be expandable in Taylor series on the whole of $\mathbb{R}$. They are three transcendental (not algebraic) functions.

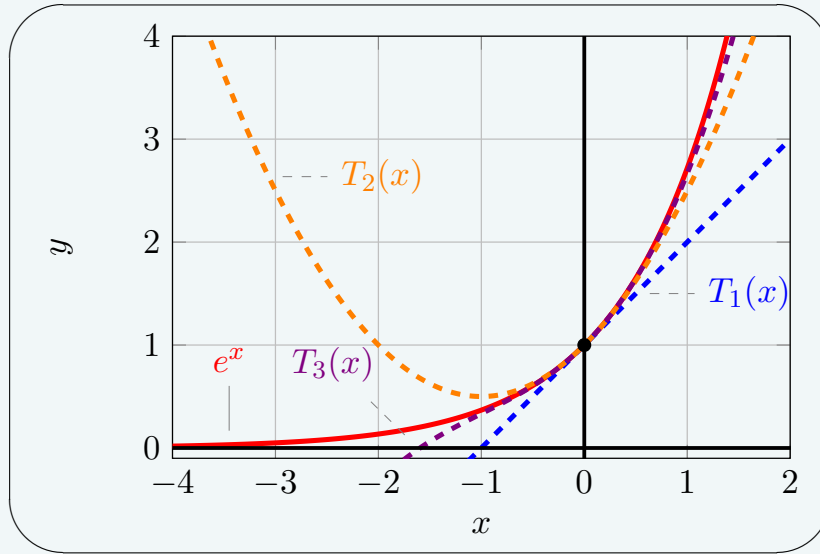
- Real functions of a real variable are classified into **algebraic functions and transcendental functions**. Algebraic functions are built through a finite number of applications of the four arithmetic operations, of raising to a power and of extracting the n -th root. Transcendental functions are all the functions that are not algebraic.

4.1.1.1 The Taylor series of the exponential function

Example 4.1: Maclaurin formula/expansion of the exponential

Maclaurin formula/expansion of order n of the exponential with Lagrange remainder:

$$e^x = T_n(x) + \frac{e^c}{(n+1)!} x^{n+1} = 1 + x + \frac{x^2}{2} + \frac{x^3}{3!} + \dots + \frac{x^n}{n!} + \frac{e^c}{(n+1)!} x^{n+1} \quad \text{with } c \in [0, x]$$


Observation 4.3: Taylor series of the exponential function

$$\forall x \in \mathbb{R}, \quad e^x = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{x^k}{k!}$$

Proof. From the Maclaurin expansion of order n of e^x with Lagrange remainder, we have that for every integer n and $x \in \mathbb{R}$ there exists a point c , lying between 0 and x , such that:

$$e^x = \sum_{k=0}^n \frac{x^k}{k!} + \frac{e^c}{(n+1)!} x^{n+1}$$

We fix x and let n tend to $+\infty$. The point c may vary with n but, since it always lies between 0 and x , we have:

$$e^c \leq \begin{cases} e^x & \text{if } x > 0 \\ 1 & \text{if } x < 0 \end{cases}$$

and $e^0 = 1$, hence e^c stays bounded. From the hierarchy of infinities theorem we have:

$$\frac{x^{n+1}}{(n+1)!} \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } n \rightarrow +\infty$$

hence the error tends to zero, that is:

$$\frac{x^{n+1}}{(n+1)!} e^c \rightarrow 0 \quad \text{as } n \rightarrow +\infty$$

since it is the product of an infinitesimal sequence and a bounded one. We have therefore proved that the function e^x can be written as the sum of a power series, its Taylor series, convergent for every $x \in \mathbb{R}$. $\square$

Observation 4.4

$$e = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{k!} \quad (4.3)$$

Proof. It suffices to set x equal to 1 in the Taylor series of the exponential function. $\square$

- We have derived a second definition of Euler's number e (Napier's constant); the first one was:

$$e = \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \left(1 + \frac{1}{k}\right)^k \quad (4.4)$$

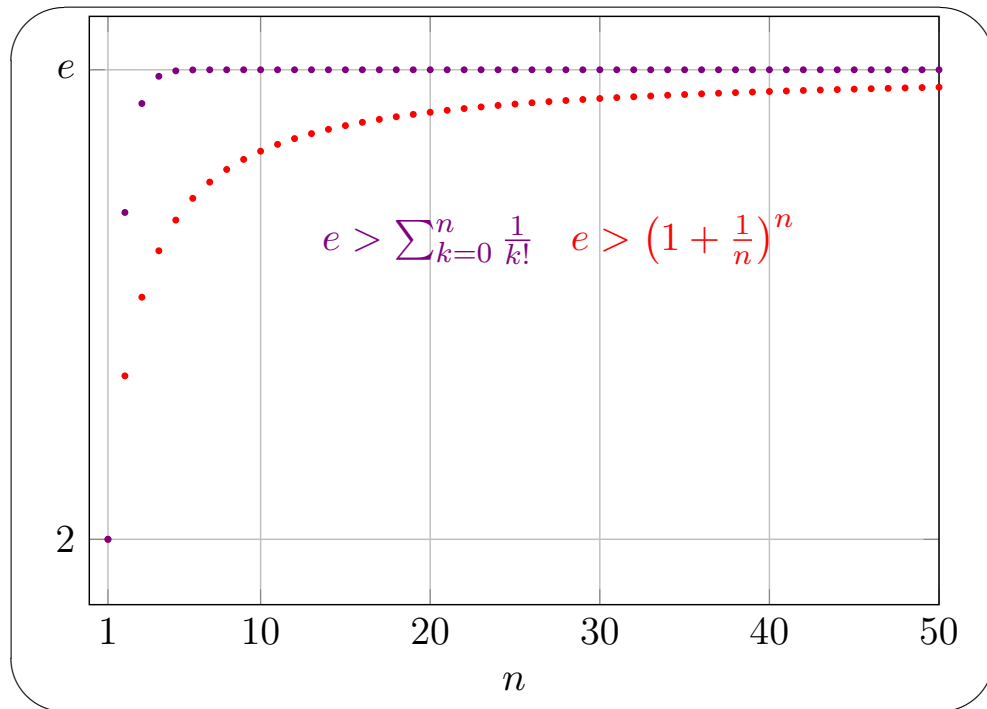
- Consequently, we have two methods for computing an approximation of the value of e :
 1. The first method is based on formula (4.4), and by fixing $k = n$ we obtain the approximation:

$$e \approx \left(1 + \frac{1}{n}\right)^n$$

2. The second method is based on formula (4.3), and by computing the n -th partial sum we obtain the approximation:

$$e \approx \sum_{k=0}^n \frac{1}{k!}$$

	$\left(1 + \frac{1}{n}\right)^n$	$\sum_{k=0}^n \frac{1}{k!}$	e
$n = 1$	2.0000000000...	2.0000000000...	2,7182818284...
$n = 2$	2.2500000000...	2.5000000000...	2,7182818284...
$n = 3$	2.3703703704...	2.6666666666...	2,7182818284...
$n = 4$	2.4414062500...	2.7083333333...	2,7182818284...
$n = 5$	2.4883200000...	2.7166666666...	2,7182818284...



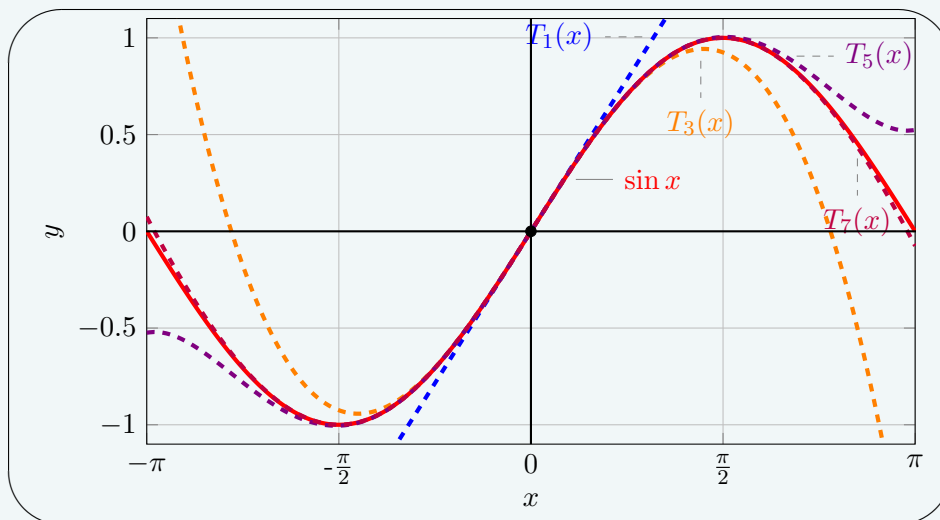
- The second method is therefore much more efficient at approximating the value of e

4.1.1.2 The Taylor series of the elementary trigonometric functions

Example 4.2: Maclaurin formula/expansion of sine and cosine

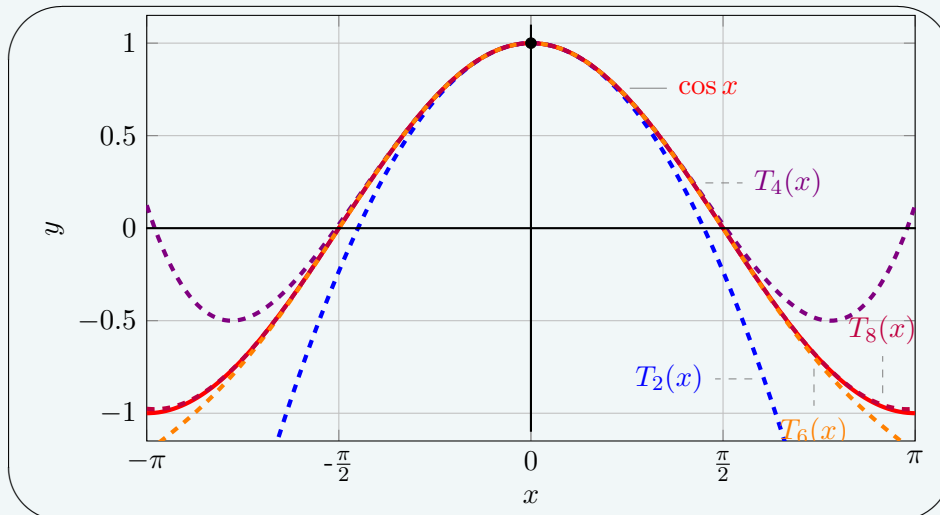
Maclaurin formula/expansion of odd order of the sine with Lagrange remainder:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \sin x &= T_{2k+1}(x) + \frac{\sin^{(2k+2)}(c)}{(2k+2)!} x^{2k+2} \\
 &= x - \frac{x^3}{3!} + \frac{x^5}{5!} - \dots + (-1)^k \frac{x^{2k+1}}{(2k+1)!} + \frac{\sin^{(2k+2)}(c)}{(2k+2)!} x^{2k+2} \quad \text{with } c \in [0, x]
 \end{aligned}$$



Maclaurin formula/expansion of even order of the cosine with Lagrange remainder:

$$\begin{aligned}\cos x &= T_{2k}(x) + \frac{\cos^{(2k+1)}(c)}{(2k+1)!} x^{2k+1} \\ &= 1 - \frac{x^2}{2!} + \frac{x^4}{4!} - \cdots + (-1)^k \frac{x^{2k}}{(2k)!} + \frac{\cos^{(2k+1)}(c)}{(2k+1)!} x^{2k+1} \quad \text{with } c \in [0, x]\end{aligned}$$



Observation 4.5: Taylor series of the elementary trigonometric functions

$$\forall x \in \mathbb{R}, \quad \sin x = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (-1)^k \frac{x^{2k+1}}{(2k+1)!}, \quad \cos x = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (-1)^k \frac{x^{2k}}{(2k)!}$$

Proof.



4.2 Series in the complex field

Exercises

The sheets of worked exercises on the topics of this volume, one per section, with the solution right after each statement. The sheets are by Fabio Furini and Gianluca Priori; many exercises are taken from M. Bramanti, *Esercitazioni di Analisi matematica 1*, Esculapio.

5.1 Numerical series

Exercise 5.1

Determine, as $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ varies, the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{(e^{\alpha^2-3})^n}{\log(1+n)}$$

Solution

This is a series with positive terms. Applying the ratio test, we obtain

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{(e^{\alpha^2-3})^{n+1}}{\log(1+n+1)} \frac{\log(1+n)}{(e^{\alpha^2-3})^n} = e^{\alpha^2-3}$$

The test guarantees that the given series converges for $-\sqrt{3} < \alpha < \sqrt{3}$ and diverges for $\alpha < -\sqrt{3}$ and for $\alpha > \sqrt{3}$, while it gives no information for $\alpha = \pm\sqrt{3}$. For $\alpha = \pm\sqrt{3}$, the series becomes

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{\log(1+n)}$$

which diverges by the comparison test, since

$$a_n = \frac{1}{\log(1+n)} > \frac{1}{n}$$

and the latter is the general term of the harmonic series, which diverges. Overall, the given series converges for $-\sqrt{3} < \alpha < \sqrt{3}$, while it diverges for $\alpha \leq -\sqrt{3}$ and for $\alpha \geq \sqrt{3}$.

Exercise 5.2

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{\log n}{n^3}$$

Solution

First of all, we observe that the necessary condition for convergence is satisfied. Moreover, we have

$$a_n = \frac{\log n}{n^3} < \frac{n}{n^3} = \frac{1}{n^2}$$

By comparison with the generalized harmonic series with exponent $p = 2$, the given series converges.

Exercise 5.3

Determine, as $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ varies, the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{n^{2-\alpha}}{\arctan \frac{1}{n^2} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n}}}$$

Solution

This is a series with positive terms. Since

$$\arctan \frac{1}{n^2} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n}} = \frac{1}{n^2} + o\left(\frac{1}{n^2}\right) + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n}} \sim \frac{1}{\sqrt{n}}$$

we have

$$a_n = \frac{n^{2-\alpha}}{\arctan \frac{1}{n^2} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{n}}} \sim \frac{n^{2-\alpha}}{\frac{1}{\sqrt{n}}} = \frac{1}{n^{\alpha-\frac{5}{2}}}$$

Therefore, by the limit comparison test, the series converges for $\alpha - \frac{5}{2} > 1$, that is, if and only if $\alpha > \frac{7}{2}$.

Exercise 5.4

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n \sin\left(n\frac{\pi}{2}\right)}{2n+5}$$

Solution

Observing that

$$\sin\left(n\frac{\pi}{2}\right) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } n \text{ is even, that is } n = 2k, \\ (-1)^k & \text{if } n \text{ is odd, that is } n = 2k + 1. \end{cases}$$

the given series is actually summed only over the odd indices and can be rewritten in the form

$$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n \sin\left(n\frac{\pi}{2}\right)}{2n+5} = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^{2k+1}(-1)^k}{2(2k+1)+5} = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^{k+1}}{4k+7}$$

The latter is an alternating series; it does not converge absolutely, since $\left|\frac{(-1)^{k+1}}{4k+7}\right| = \frac{1}{4k+7} \sim \frac{1}{4k}$ as $k \rightarrow +\infty$, where the last one is the general term of a harmonic series (which diverges). However, the given series converges (conditionally) by the Leibniz test. Indeed, it is immediate to prove that the sequence defined by $a_k = \frac{1}{4k+7}$ is positive, infinitesimal and monotonically decreasing.

Exercise 5.5

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=2}^{\infty} \frac{1 - \sqrt{1 - \frac{2}{n}}}{n}$$

Solution

Recalling that $\sqrt{1 - \frac{2}{n}} = 1 - \frac{1}{2}\frac{2}{n} + o\left(\frac{1}{n}\right)$, we have

$$a_n = \frac{1 - \sqrt{1 - \frac{2}{n}}}{n} = \frac{1 - 1 + \frac{1}{2}\frac{2}{n} + o\left(\frac{1}{n}\right)}{n} \sim \frac{\frac{1}{n}}{n} = \frac{1}{n^2}$$

which is the general term of the generalized harmonic series with exponent $2 > 1$. Therefore the original series converges by the limit comparison test.

Exercise 5.6

Determine, as $x \in \mathbb{R}$ varies, the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{e^{2/n} - 1 - \frac{x}{n}}{\sqrt{\frac{1}{n}}}$$

Solution

Left as an exercise. Use the second-order Maclaurin expansion of e^t , with $t = \frac{2}{n}$. By limit comparison with the generalized harmonic series, the given series will turn out to be divergent for $x \neq 2$ and convergent for $x = 2$.

Exercise 5.7

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \log \left(\frac{n^2 + 3\sqrt{n}}{n^2 + 4} \right)$$

Solution

This is a series with positive terms. Since

$$\log \left(\frac{n^2 + 3\sqrt{n}}{n^2 + 4} \right) = \log \left(1 + \frac{n^2 + 3\sqrt{n}}{n^2 + 4} - 1 \right) \sim \frac{n^2 + 3\sqrt{n}}{n^2 + 4} - 1$$

Then

$$a_n = \log \left(\frac{n^2 + 3\sqrt{n}}{n^2 + 4} \right) \sim \frac{n^2 + 3\sqrt{n}}{n^2 + 4} - 1 = \frac{3\sqrt{n} - 4}{n^2 + 4} \sim 3 \frac{1}{n^{\frac{3}{2}}}$$

Therefore, by comparison with the generalized harmonic series with exponent $\frac{3}{2} > 1$, it follows that the series converges by the limit comparison test.

Exercise 5.8

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{e^{\frac{1}{n}} - 1}{n + 1}$$

Solution

This is a series with positive terms. Since

$$e^{\frac{1}{n}} - 1 \sim \frac{1}{n}$$

we immediately have

$$a_n = \frac{e^{\frac{1}{n}} - 1}{n + 1} \sim \frac{\frac{1}{n}}{n} = \frac{1}{n^2}$$

Therefore, by comparison with the generalized harmonic series with exponent $2 > 1$, it follows that the series converges by the limit comparison test.

Exercise 5.9

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(e^{\frac{n^2+2n}{n^2+1}} - e \right)$$

Solution

This is a series with positive terms. We have

$$a_n = e^{\frac{n^2+2n}{n^2+1}} - e = e \left(e^{\frac{n^2+2n}{n^2+1} - 1} - 1 \right) = e \left(e^{\frac{2n-1}{n^2+1}} - 1 \right) \sim e \frac{2n-1}{n^2+1} \sim 2e \frac{1}{n}$$

which is the general term of the harmonic series. We used the fact that $\frac{2n-1}{n^2+1} \rightarrow 0$ and also $\frac{2n-1}{n^2+1} \sim \frac{2}{n}$ as $n \rightarrow +\infty$. Therefore, the original series diverges by the limit comparison test.

Exercise 5.10

Determine, as $\alpha > 0$ varies, the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(\sin \frac{1}{n^{3\alpha}} \right) n^{\frac{3}{2}-2\alpha}$$

Solution

This is a series with positive terms. Since

$$\sin \frac{1}{n^{3\alpha}} \sim \frac{1}{n^{3\alpha}}$$

then we immediately have

$$a_n = \left(\sin \frac{1}{n^{3\alpha}} \right) n^{\frac{3}{2}-2\alpha} \sim \frac{n^{\frac{3}{2}-2\alpha}}{n^{3\alpha}} = \frac{1}{n^{5\alpha-\frac{3}{2}}}$$

Therefore, by the limit comparison test, the series converges for $5\alpha - \frac{3}{2} > 1$, that is, if and only if $\alpha > \frac{1}{2}$.

Exercise 5.11

Determine, as $\alpha > 0$ varies, the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(\sqrt{1 + \frac{1}{n^\alpha}} - 1 \right) n^{2-\alpha}$$

Solution

This is a series with positive terms. Since

$$\sqrt{1 + \frac{1}{n^\alpha}} - 1 \sim \frac{1}{2} \frac{1}{n^\alpha}$$

then

$$a_n = \left(\sqrt{1 + \frac{1}{n^\alpha}} - 1 \right) n^{2-\alpha} \sim \frac{1}{2n^\alpha} n^{2-\alpha} = \frac{1}{2n^{2\alpha-2}}$$

Therefore, by the limit comparison test, the series converges for $2\alpha - 2 > 1$, that is, if and only if $\alpha > \frac{3}{2}$.

Exercise 5.12

Determine, as $\alpha > 0$ varies, the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \left(\cos \frac{1}{n^\alpha} - 1 \right) n^{1-\alpha}$$

Solution

The given series has negative terms (think about the cosine of an angle between 0 and 1). Therefore, we can apply to it the tests for series with positive terms, factoring out the negative sign. Observing that, for $\alpha > 0$,

$$\left(\cos \frac{1}{n^\alpha} - 1 \right) n^{1-\alpha} \sim -\frac{n^{1-\alpha}}{2n^{2\alpha}} = -\frac{1}{2n^{3\alpha-1}}$$

we immediately obtain that, by the limit comparison test, the given series converges for $3\alpha - 1 > 1$, i.e., $\alpha > \frac{2}{3}$.

Exercise 5.13

Determine, as $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ varies, the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{|\alpha^2 - 5\alpha + 7|^n}{3n^2 + \log n}$$

Solution

First of all, we observe that this is a series with positive terms, since $\alpha^2 - 5\alpha + 7 > 0$ for every $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$. Using the root test, we obtain

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \sqrt[n]{\frac{|\alpha^2 - 5\alpha + 7|^n}{3n^2 + \log n}} = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{|\alpha^2 - 5\alpha + 7|}{\sqrt[n]{3n^2 + \log n}} = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{|\alpha^2 - 5\alpha + 7|}{\sqrt[3]{3} \sqrt[n]{n^2}} = |\alpha^2 - 5\alpha + 7|$$

where we took into account the hierarchy of infinities and the limit $\sqrt[n]{n^2} \rightarrow 1$. Since $|\alpha^2 - 5\alpha + 7| < 1$ is satisfied if and only if $2 < \alpha < 3$, while $|\alpha^2 - 5\alpha + 7| > 1$ is satisfied if and only if $\alpha < 2$ or $\alpha > 3$, and $|\alpha^2 - 5\alpha + 7| = 1$ if and only if $\alpha = 2$ or $\alpha = 3$, the test guarantees that the given series

- converges for $2 < \alpha < 3$;
- diverges for $\alpha < 2$ or $\alpha > 3$.

For $\alpha = 2$ or $\alpha = 3$, the given series has general term $a_n = \frac{1}{3n^2 + \log n} \sim \frac{1}{3n^2}$, which satisfies the necessary condition, and the series converges by limit comparison with the generalized harmonic series with exponent $2 > 1$.

Exercise 5.14

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{n \left(\sqrt{1 + \frac{3}{n^3}} - 1 \right)}$$

Solution

This is a series with positive terms. Since

$$\sqrt{1 + \frac{3}{n^3}} - 1 \sim \frac{1}{2} \frac{3}{n^3}$$

then

$$a_n = \frac{1}{n \left(\sqrt{1 + \frac{3}{n^3}} - 1 \right)} \sim \frac{1}{n \left(\frac{3}{2n^3} \right)} = \frac{2}{3} n^2$$

Therefore the given series diverges since its general term is not infinitesimal.

Exercise 5.15

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} e^{\sin n} \left(\sin \frac{1}{n} \right) \left(e^{\frac{1}{\sqrt{n}}} - 1 \right) \cos n$$

Solution

Left as an exercise. The given series converges absolutely and hence it also converges.

Exercise 5.16

Determine, as $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ varies, the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=2}^{\infty} \frac{[2(\log n)^{\alpha-7}]^n}{n^2}$$

Solution

Left as an exercise. Apply the root test. The given series converges for $\alpha < 7$ and diverges for $\alpha \geq 7$.

Exercise 5.17

Determine, as $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ varies, the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{4^n}{n^3(7^{\alpha+2})^n}$$

Solution

Left as an exercise. Apply the root test. The given series converges for $\alpha \geq \frac{\log 4}{\log 7} - 2$.

Exercise 5.18

Determine, as $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ varies, the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \left[\cos \left(\frac{1}{n+2} \right)^{\alpha} - 1 \right] n^4$$

Solution

The given series has negative terms (think about the cosine of an angle between 0 and 1). Therefore, we can apply to it the tests for series with positive terms, factoring out the negative sign. Observing that

$$\left[\cos \left(\frac{1}{n+2} \right)^{\alpha} - 1 \right] n^4 \sim -\frac{n^4}{2(n+2)^{2\alpha}} \sim -\frac{n^4}{2n^{2\alpha}} = -\frac{1}{2n^{2\alpha-4}}$$

we immediately obtain that, by the limit comparison test, the given series converges for $2\alpha - 4 > 1$, i.e., $\alpha > \frac{5}{2}$.

Exercise 5.19

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \binom{n}{4} \frac{1}{3^n}$$

Solution

Work it out as an exercise using the ratio test. The given series converges.

Exercise 5.20

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{\sqrt{n!}}{(\sqrt{n})^n}$$

Solution

This is a series with positive terms. Applying the ratio test, we obtain

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{a_{n+1}}{a_n} = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \frac{\sqrt{(n+1)!}}{(\sqrt{n+1})^{n+1}} \frac{(\sqrt{n})^n}{\sqrt{n!}} = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \left(\sqrt{\frac{n}{n+1}} \right)^n$$

Recalling the fundamental limit

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \left(1 + \frac{1}{n} \right)^n = e$$

we obtain

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \left(\sqrt{\frac{n}{n+1}} \right)^n = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \left(\sqrt{\frac{n+1}{n}} \right)^{-n} = \lim_{n \rightarrow +\infty} \left(1 + \frac{1}{n} \right)^{-\frac{1}{2}n} = e^{-\frac{1}{2}} = l$$

Since $l = e^{-\frac{1}{2}} < 1$, the given series converges.

Exercise 5.21

Determine, as $\alpha > 0$ varies, the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \left[\log \left(\frac{n+2}{n+1} \right) \right]^\alpha$$

Solution

Left as an exercise. Add and subtract 1 inside the argument of the logarithm and use a suitable asymptotic estimate. The given series converges for $\alpha > 1$.

Exercise 5.22

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n \left(\frac{2}{\sqrt{n}} - \sin \frac{2}{\sqrt{n}} \right)^2$$

Solution

Left as an exercise. It suffices to expand the general term of the series up to the first nonzero term of the expansion. The given series converges.

Exercise 5.23

Determine, as $x \in \mathbb{R}$ varies, the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{|x - 12|^{n+1}}{2n^2 e^{-n}}$$

Solution

Left as an exercise. Use the ratio test. The given series converges for $12 - \frac{1}{e} \leq x \leq 12 + \frac{1}{e}$ and diverges elsewhere.

Exercise 5.24

Determine, as $x \in \mathbb{R}$ varies, the behavior of the following series:

$$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(\frac{x}{|x-1|} \right)^n$$

Solution

This is a geometric series with ratio $q = \frac{x}{|x-1|}$, defined for $x \neq 1$. The series converges absolutely (and hence also converges) if and only if

$$\left| \frac{x}{x-1} \right| < 1$$

that is, if and only if

$$-1 < \frac{x}{x-1} < 1$$

whose solution interval is $x < \frac{1}{2}$.

Exercise 5.25

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{\cos(n\pi) e^{-2n} \log n}{n}$$

Solution

Recall that $\cos(n\pi) = (-1)^n$; therefore the series is alternating. Since $\log n < n$ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we have:

$$|a_n| = \left| (-1)^n \frac{e^{-2n} \log n}{n} \right| = e^{-2n} \left(\frac{\log n}{n} \right) < \left(\frac{1}{e^2} \right)^n$$

where the last one is the general term of the geometric series with ratio $q = \frac{1}{e^2} < 1$, which converges. By the comparison test we obtain that the given series converges absolutely, hence it also converges.

Exercise 5.26

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{1 + n \cos(n\pi)}{2n^2 + 1}$$

Solution

Left as an exercise. Observe that $\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{2n^2+1}$ is convergent, hence it is possible to rewrite

$$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{1 + n \cos(n\pi)}{2n^2 + 1} = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{2n^2 + 1} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{n \cos(n\pi)}{2n^2 + 1}$$

where $\cos(n\pi) = (-1)^n$. Determine the behavior of the second series; one will verify that it converges (conditionally) by the Leibniz test and that, in the end, the given series converges as a sum of convergent series.

Exercise 5.27

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} (-1)^n \frac{\cos n}{3n^2 + 2\sqrt{n}}$$

Solution

The given series is alternating. Setting $a_n = (-1)^n \frac{\cos n}{3n^2 + 2\sqrt{n}}$, we have

$$|a_n| = \left| (-1)^n \frac{\cos n}{3n^2 + 2\sqrt{n}} \right| = \frac{|\cos n|}{3n^2 + 2\sqrt{n}} \leq \frac{1}{3n^2 + 2\sqrt{n}} \sim \frac{1}{3n^2}$$

where we used the fact that $|\cos n| \leq 1$ for every n and $3n^2 + 2\sqrt{n} \sim 3n^2$ as $n \rightarrow +\infty$. By the limit comparison test with the generalized harmonic series with exponent $2 > 1$ and by the comparison test, the given series converges absolutely, and hence it also converges.

Exercise 5.28

Determine the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=2}^{\infty} (-1)^n \frac{1 - \sin^2(n\pi/2)}{3n + \sin n}$$

Solution

This is an alternating series. Observing that

$$\sin^2(n\pi/2) = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } n \text{ is even, that is } n = 2k, \\ 1 & \text{if } n \text{ is odd, that is } n = 2k + 1. \end{cases}$$

and setting $a_n = \frac{1 - \sin^2(n\pi/2)}{3n + \sin n}$, we have

$$a_n = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{3n + \sin n} & \text{if } n = 2k, \\ 0 & \text{if } n = 2k + 1. \end{cases}$$

Hence the given series can be rewritten in the form

$$\sum_{n=2}^{\infty} (-1)^n \frac{1}{3n + \sin n} = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} (-1)^{2k} \frac{1}{6k + \sin(2k)} = \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{6k + \sin(2k)}$$

where, for the second equality, we used the fact that $n = 2k$. The last series obtained has positive terms. Since, as $k \rightarrow +\infty$, $\frac{1}{6k + \sin(2k)} \sim \frac{1}{6k}$, the limit comparison test with the harmonic series shows that the given series diverges.

Exercise 5.29

Determine, as $x \in \mathbb{R}$ varies, the behavior of the following series, making appropriate use of the tests studied:

$$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(\frac{2x}{1 - x^2} \right)^n$$

.

Solution

Left as an exercise. Argue as in exercise 24.

Exercises on antiderivatives and integrals

The sheets of worked exercises of Part 6 of the course (antiderivatives and definite integrals), with the solution right after each statement. The sheets are by Fabio Furini and Gianluca Priori; many exercises are taken from M. Bramanti, *Esercitazioni di Analisi matematica 1*, Esculapio.

A.1 Antiderivatives

Exercise A.1

Compute the following antiderivatives on the intervals where they are defined

$$(a) \int \left(2x + \sqrt[3]{x} - \frac{2}{\sqrt{x}} \right) dx, \quad (b) \int \frac{x - x^4}{\sqrt{x}} dx$$

$$(c) \int \tan^2 x \, dx, \quad (d) \int (3 - x)^5 dx$$

$$(e) \int \frac{1}{2 - 3x} dx, \quad (f) \int x^2 e^{x^3+1} dx$$

$$(g) \int x \sqrt{x^2 + 1} dx, \quad (h) \int \frac{\sin 2x}{1 + \sin^2 x} dx$$

$$(i) \int \frac{e^x}{e^x + 3} dx, \quad (j) \int \frac{1}{\tan x} dx$$

Solution

(a)

$$\begin{aligned} \int \left(2x + \sqrt[3]{x} - \frac{2}{\sqrt{x}} \right) dx &= \int (2x + x^{1/3} - 2x^{-1/2}) dx \\ &= x^2 + \frac{3}{4}x^{4/3} - 4x^{1/2} + c = x^2 + \frac{3}{4}\sqrt[4]{x^4} - 4\sqrt{x} + c \end{aligned}$$

on any interval I such that $I \subset (0, +\infty)$.

Solution

(b)

$$\int \frac{x - x^4}{\sqrt{x}} dx = \int (x^{1/2} - x^{7/2}) dx =$$

$$\frac{2}{3}x^{3/2} - \frac{2}{9}x^{9/2} + c = \frac{2}{3}x\sqrt{x} - \frac{2}{9}x^4\sqrt{x} + c$$

on any interval I such that $I \subset (0, +\infty)$.

Solution

(c)

$$\int \tan^2 x \, dx = \int [(1 + \tan^2 x) - 1] dx = \tan x - x + c$$

on any interval I that does not contain points of the form $\pi/2 + k\pi$ with $k \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Solution

(d)

$$\int (3 - x)^5 dx = - \int (x - 3)^5 dx = -\frac{1}{6}(x - 3)^6 + c$$

on any interval I of $\mathbb{R}$.

Solution

(e)

$$\int \frac{1}{2 - 3x} dx = - \int \frac{1}{3x - 2} dx = -\frac{1}{3} \log |3x - 2| + c$$

on any interval I such that $2/3 \notin I$.

Solution

(f)

$$\int x^2 e^{x^3+1} dx = \frac{1}{3} e^{x^3+1} + c$$

on any interval I of $\mathbb{R}$.

Solution

(g)

$$\int x \sqrt{x^2 + 1} dx = \frac{1}{3} (x^2 + 1)^{3/2} + c = \frac{1}{3} (x^2 + 1) \sqrt{x^2 + 1} + c$$

on any interval I of $\mathbb{R}$.

Solution

(h)

$$\int \frac{\sin 2x}{1 + \sin^2 x} dx = \int \frac{2 \sin x \cos x}{1 + \sin^2 x} dx = \log(1 + \sin^2 x) + c$$

on any interval I of $\mathbb{R}$.**Solution**

(i)

$$\int \frac{e^x}{e^x + 3} dx = \log(e^x + 3) + c$$

on any interval I of $\mathbb{R}$.**Solution**

(j)

$$\int \frac{1}{\tan x} dx = \int \frac{\cos x}{\sin x} dx = \log |\sin x| + c$$

on any interval I that does not contain points of the form $k\pi$ with $k \in \mathbb{Z}$.**Exercise A.2**

Compute the following antiderivatives using integration by parts

$$(a) \int x \sin x \, dx, \quad (b) \int x^2 \cos x \, dx$$

$$(c) \int \arcsin x \, dx, \quad (d) \int \sin^2 x \, dx$$

Solution

(a)

$$\int x \sin x \, dx = -x \cos x + \int \cos x \, dx = -x \cos x + \sin x + c$$

on any interval I of $\mathbb{R}$.

Solution

(b) Integrating by parts twice in a row, we have

$$\begin{aligned}\int x^2 \cos x \, dx &= x^2 \sin x - 2 \int x \sin x \, dx = \\ &= x^2 \sin x + 2x \cos x - 2 \int \cos x \, dx = x^2 \sin x + 2x \cos x - 2 \sin x + c\end{aligned}$$

on any interval I of $\mathbb{R}$.

Solution

(c) Taking the constant function 1 as the factor to be integrated, we have

$$\int \arcsin x \, dx = x \arcsin x - \int \frac{x}{\sqrt{1-x^2}} dx = x \arcsin x + \sqrt{1-x^2} + c$$

on any interval $I \subset (-1, 1)$.

Solution

(d) Integrating by parts and using $\cos^2 x = 1 - \sin^2 x$, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned}\int \sin^2 x \, dx &= -\sin x \cos x + \int \cos^2 x \, dx \\ &= -\sin x \cos x + \int 1 \, dx - \int \sin^2 x \, dx\end{aligned}$$

from which

$$\int \sin^2 x \, dx = -\sin x \cos x + x - \int \sin^2 x \, dx + c$$

hence, moving $\int \sin^2 x \, dx$ to the left-hand side,

$$2 \int \sin^2 x \, dx = -\sin x \cos x + x + c$$

and finally, still denoting by c the arbitrary constant $c/2$,

$$\int \sin^2 x \, dx = -\frac{1}{2} \sin x \cos x + \frac{1}{2} x + c$$

on any interval I of $\mathbb{R}$.

Exercise A.3

Compute the following antiderivatives using integration by substitution

$$(a) \int \frac{e^x - 1}{e^x + 1} dx, \quad (b) \int \frac{\sqrt{x}}{1+x} dx, \quad (c) \int x\sqrt{x+1} dx$$

Solution

(a) Setting $y = e^x$, $y > 0$, $x \in \mathbb{R}$, we have $x = \log y$ and we write $dx = \frac{1}{y} dy$, hence

$$\int \frac{e^x - 1}{e^x + 1} dx = \int \frac{y - 1}{y(y + 1)} dy.$$

Using partial fractions, we obtain

$$\frac{y - 1}{y(y + 1)} = -\frac{1}{y} + \frac{2}{y + 1}$$

from which, taking into account that $y > 0$,

$$\int \frac{y - 1}{y(y + 1)} dy = -\log y + 2 \log(y + 1) + c.$$

It follows, substituting back $y = e^x$,

$$\int \frac{e^x - 1}{e^x + 1} dx = -\log e^x + 2 \log(e^x + 1) + c = -x + 2 \log(e^x + 1) + c$$

on any interval I of $\mathbb{R}$.

Solution

(b) Setting $y = \sqrt{x}$, $x, y > 0$, we have $x = y^2$ and we write $dx = 2y dy$, hence

$$\int \frac{\sqrt{x}}{1+x} dx = 2 \int \frac{y^2}{1+y^2} dy.$$

From

$$\frac{y^2}{y^2 + 1} = \frac{y^2 + 1 - 1}{y^2 + 1} = 1 - \frac{1}{y^2 + 1}$$

we then have

$$2 \int \frac{y^2}{1+y^2} dy = 2y - 2 \arctan y + c.$$

It follows, substituting back $y = \sqrt{x}$,

$$\int \frac{\sqrt{x}}{1+x} dx = 2\sqrt{x} - 2 \arctan \sqrt{x} + c$$

on any interval $I \subset (0, +\infty)$.

Solution

(c) Setting $y = \sqrt{x+1}$, $x > -1$, $y > 0$, we have $x = y^2 - 1$ and we write $dx = 2y \, dy$, hence

$$\int x\sqrt{x+1}dx = 2 \int (y^2 - 1)y^2 \, dy = 2 \int (y^4 - y^2)dy = \frac{2}{5}y^5 - \frac{2}{3}y^3 + c.$$

It follows, substituting back $y = \sqrt{x+1}$,

$$\int x\sqrt{x+1}dx = \frac{2}{5}(x+1)^{5/2} - \frac{2}{3}(x+1)^{3/2} + c$$

on any interval $I \subset (-1, +\infty)$.

Exercise A.4

Compute the following antiderivatives of rational functions

(a) $\int \frac{5}{x^2 + 2x + 1} dx$, (b) $\int \frac{1}{x^2 + x + 1} dx$, (c) $\int \frac{x}{x^2 + x + 1} dx$, (d) $\int \frac{x^3 + 1}{x^2 - 3x + 2} dx$

(e) $\int \frac{x}{x^3 + 3x^2 + 3x + 1} dx$, (f) $\int \frac{1}{x^4 - 1} dx$, (g) $\int \frac{x+1}{x^3 - x^2} dx$, (h) $\int \frac{1}{x^3 + 1} dx$

Solution

(a) The given integral is immediate:

$$\int \frac{5}{x^2 + 2x + 1} dx = \int \frac{5}{(x+1)^2} dx = -\frac{5}{x+1} + c$$

on any interval I such that $-1 \notin I$.

Solution

(b) Writing the (irreducible) denominator as a sum of squares:

$$\int \frac{1}{x^2 + x + 1} dx = \int \frac{1}{(x + 1/2)^2 + 3/4} dx = \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} \arctan \left[\frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} \left(x + \frac{1}{2} \right) \right] + c$$

on any interval I of $\mathbb{R}$.

Solution

(c) Using also the previous exercise:

$$\int \frac{x}{x^2 + x + 1} dx = \frac{1}{2} \int \frac{2x + 1}{x^2 + x + 1} dx - \frac{1}{2} \int \frac{1}{x^2 + x + 1} dx =$$

$$\frac{1}{2} \log(x^2 + x + 1) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} \arctan \left[\frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} \left(x + \frac{1}{2} \right) \right] + c$$

on any interval I of $\mathbb{R}$.

Solution

(d) We perform polynomial long division:

$$\frac{x^3 + 1}{x^2 - 3x + 2} = x + 3 + \frac{7x - 5}{x^2 - 3x + 2}.$$

Setting up the partial fractions

$$\frac{7x - 5}{x^2 - 3x + 2} = \frac{7x - 5}{(x - 1)(x - 2)} = \frac{A}{x - 1} + \frac{B}{x - 2},$$

we obtain

$$A = -2, \quad B = 9.$$

In conclusion:

$$\int \frac{x^3 + 1}{x^2 - 3x + 2} dx = \int \left(x + 3 - \frac{2}{x - 1} + \frac{9}{x - 2} \right) dx =$$

$$\frac{1}{2} x^2 + 3x - 2 \log |x - 1| + 9 \log |x - 2| + c$$

on any interval I such that $1 \notin I, 2 \notin I$.

Solution

(e) We set up the partial fractions:

$$\frac{x}{x^3 + 3x^2 + 3x + 1} = \frac{x}{(x + 1)^3} = \frac{A}{x + 1} + \frac{B}{(x + 1)^2} + \frac{C}{(x + 1)^3}.$$

We obtain

$$A = 0, \quad B = 1, \quad C = -1.$$

In conclusion

$$\int \frac{x}{x^3 + 3x^2 + 3x + 1} dx = \int \left(\frac{1}{(x + 1)^2} - \frac{1}{(x + 1)^3} \right) dx$$

$$= -\frac{1}{x + 1} + \frac{1}{2} \frac{1}{(x + 1)^2} + c$$

on any interval I such that $-1 \notin I$.

Solution

(f) We set up the partial fractions:

$$\frac{1}{x^4 - 1} = \frac{1}{(x-1)(x+1)(x^2+1)} = \frac{A}{x-1} + \frac{B}{x+1} + \frac{Cx+D}{x^2+1}.$$

We obtain

$$A = \frac{1}{4}, \quad B = -\frac{1}{4}, \quad C = 0, \quad D = -\frac{1}{2}.$$

In conclusion

$$\begin{aligned} \int \frac{1}{x^4 - 1} dx &= \int \left(\frac{1}{4} \frac{1}{x-1} - \frac{1}{4} \frac{1}{x+1} - \frac{1}{2} \frac{1}{x^2+1} \right) dx \\ &= \frac{1}{4} \log |x-1| - \frac{1}{4} \log |x+1| - \frac{1}{2} \arctan x + c \end{aligned}$$

on any interval I such that $\pm 1 \notin I$.

Solution

(g) We set up the partial fractions:

$$\frac{x+1}{x^3 - x^2} = \frac{x+1}{x^2(x-1)} = \frac{A}{x} + \frac{B}{x^2} + \frac{C}{x-1}.$$

We obtain

$$A = -2, \quad B = -1, \quad C = 2.$$

In conclusion

$$\begin{aligned} \int \frac{x+1}{x^3 - x^2} dx &= \int \left(-\frac{2}{x} - \frac{1}{x^2} + \frac{2}{x-1} \right) dx \\ &= -2 \log |x| + \frac{1}{x} + 2 \log |x-1| + c \end{aligned}$$

on any interval I such that $0, 1 \notin I$.

Solution

(h) We set up the partial fractions:

$$\frac{1}{x^3 + 1} = \frac{1}{(x+1)(x^2 - x + 1)} = \frac{A}{x+1} + \frac{Bx+C}{x^2 - x + 1}.$$

We obtain

$$A = \frac{1}{3}, \quad B = -\frac{1}{3}, \quad C = \frac{2}{3}.$$

Hence

$$\begin{aligned}
 \int \frac{1}{x^3 + 1} dx &= \int \left(\frac{1}{3} \frac{1}{x+1} + \frac{1}{3} \frac{-x+2}{x^2-x+1} \right) dx \\
 &= \frac{1}{3} \log|x+1| - \frac{1}{6} \int \frac{2x-1}{x^2-x+1} dx + \frac{1}{2} \int \frac{1}{x^2-x+1} dx \\
 &= \frac{1}{3} \log|x+1| - \frac{1}{6} \log(x^2-x+1) + \frac{1}{2} \int \frac{1}{(x-1/2)^2 + 3/4} dx \\
 &= \frac{1}{3} \log|x+1| - \frac{1}{6} \log(x^2-x+1) + \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} \arctan \left[\frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} \left(x - \frac{1}{2} \right) \right] + c
 \end{aligned}$$

on any interval I such that $-1 \notin I$.

Exercise A.5

Compute the following antiderivatives

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{(a)} \quad & \int \frac{e^x + 1}{e^{2x} + 1} dx, \quad \text{(b)} \quad \int x^2 \log(x+1) dx, \quad \text{(c)} \quad \int \frac{\tan x}{\sin^2 x - \cos^2 x} dx \\
 \text{(d)} \quad & \int \frac{x + \sqrt{x}}{2 + \sqrt{x}} dx, \quad \text{(e)} \quad \int \frac{1}{\cos x} dx, \quad \text{(f)} \quad \int \sqrt{4 - x^2} dx
 \end{aligned}$$

Solution

(a) With the substitution $y = e^x$, $y > 0$, $x \in \mathbb{R}$, we have $x = \log y$, we write $dx = \frac{1}{y} dy$, and we obtain

$$\int \frac{e^x + 1}{e^{2x} + 1} dx = \int \frac{y + 1}{y(y^2 + 1)} dy.$$

We set up the partial fractions:

$$\frac{y + 1}{y(y^2 + 1)} = \frac{A}{y} + \frac{By + C}{y^2 + 1}.$$

We have

$$A = 1, \quad B = -1, \quad C = 1,$$

from which, taking into account also that $y > 0$,

$$\begin{aligned}
 \int \frac{y + 1}{y(y^2 + 1)} dy &= \int \left(\frac{1}{y} - \frac{y}{y^2 + 1} + \frac{1}{y^2 + 1} \right) dy \\
 &= \log y - \frac{1}{2} \log(y^2 + 1) + \arctan y + c.
 \end{aligned}$$

Then, substituting back $y = e^x$, we have

$$\int \frac{e^x + 1}{e^{2x} + 1} dx = x - \frac{1}{2} \log(e^{2x} + 1) + \arctan e^x + c$$

on any interval I of $\mathbb{R}$.

Solution

(b) Integrating by parts and then computing the integral of a rational function, we have

$$\begin{aligned}\int x^2 \log(x+1) dx &= \frac{1}{3} x^3 \log(x+1) - \frac{1}{3} \int \frac{x^3}{x+1} dx \\ &= \frac{1}{3} x^3 \log(x+1) - \frac{1}{3} \int (x^2 - x + 1) dx + \frac{1}{3} \int \frac{1}{x+1} dx \\ &= \frac{1}{3} x^3 \log(x+1) - \frac{1}{9} x^3 + \frac{1}{6} x^2 - \frac{1}{3} x + \frac{1}{3} \log(x+1) + c\end{aligned}$$

on any interval $I \subset (-1, +\infty)$.

Solution

(c) From $\tan x = \frac{\sin x}{\cos x}$ and $\sin^2 x = 1 - \cos^2 x$, we have

$$\int \frac{\tan x}{\sin^2 x - \cos^2 x} dx = \int \frac{\sin x}{\cos x(1 - 2\cos^2 x)} dx.$$

Now setting $y = \cos x$, we write $dy = -\sin x dx$ and we obtain

$$\int \frac{\sin x}{\cos x(1 - 2\cos^2 x)} dx = \frac{1}{2} \int \frac{1}{y(y - \sqrt{1/2})(y + \sqrt{1/2})} dy.$$

Using partial fractions, we then have

$$\frac{1}{y(y - \sqrt{1/2})(y + \sqrt{1/2})} = -\frac{2}{y} + \frac{1}{y - \sqrt{1/2}} + \frac{1}{y + \sqrt{1/2}},$$

from which

$$\frac{1}{2} \int \frac{1}{y(y - \sqrt{1/2})(y + \sqrt{1/2})} dy = -\log |y| + \frac{1}{2} \log |y^2 - 1/2| + c.$$

In conclusion,

$$\int \frac{\tan x}{\sin^2 x - \cos^2 x} dx = -\log |\cos x| + \frac{1}{2} \log |\cos^2 x - 1/2| + c$$

on any interval I that does not contain points of the form $x = \pi/2 + k\pi$ or of the form $x = \pi/4 + k\pi/2$ with k an integer.

Solution

(d) With the substitution $y = \sqrt{x}$, $x, y > 0$, we have $x = y^2$, we write $dx = 2y dy$ and we obtain

$$\int \frac{x + \sqrt{x}}{2 + \sqrt{x}} dx = 2 \int \frac{y^3 + y^2}{y + 2} dy.$$

Integrating the rational function, we have

$$\begin{aligned} 2 \int \frac{y^3 + y^2}{y + 2} dy &= 2 \int (y^2 - y + 2) dy - 8 \int \frac{1}{y + 2} dy \\ &= \frac{2}{3} y^3 - y^2 + 4y - 8 \log(y + 2) + c. \end{aligned}$$

Substituting back $y = \sqrt{x}$, we conclude

$$\int \frac{x + \sqrt{x}}{2 + \sqrt{x}} dx = \frac{2}{3} x \sqrt{x} - x + 4\sqrt{x} - 8 \log(\sqrt{x} + 2) + c$$

on any interval $I \subset (0, +\infty)$.

Solution

(e) Using the rationalizing substitution $y = \tan \frac{x}{2}$, $dx = \frac{2}{1+y^2} dy$ and taking into account that $\cos x = \frac{1-y^2}{1+y^2}$, we have

$$\int \frac{1}{\cos x} dx = -2 \int \frac{1}{y^2 - 1} dy.$$

Using partial fractions, we then have

$$-2 \int \frac{1}{y^2 - 1} dy = \int \left(\frac{1}{y + 1} - \frac{1}{y - 1} \right) dy = \log \left| \frac{y + 1}{y - 1} \right| + c.$$

Going back to $y = \tan \frac{x}{2}$, we conclude

$$\int \frac{1}{\cos x} dx = \log \left| \frac{\tan(x/2) + 1}{\tan(x/2) - 1} \right| + c$$

on any interval I that does not contain points of the form $x = \pi/2 + k\pi$ with k an integer.

Solution

(f) Using the rationalizing substitution $x = 2 \sin y$, $-\pi/2 < y < \pi/2$, $-2 < x < 2$, $dx = 2 \cos y dy$, and taking into account also that $\cos y > 0$, we obtain

$$\int \sqrt{4 - x^2} dx = 4 \int \cos^2 y dy.$$

From $4 \cos^2 y = 2 + 2 \cos(2y)$, we then have

$$4 \int \cos^2 y dy = 2y + \sin(2y) = 2y + 2 \sin y \cos y + c.$$

Now using $\sin y = x/2$, $y = \arcsin(x/2)$, $\cos y = \sqrt{1 - \sin^2 y} = \frac{1}{2} \sqrt{4 - x^2}$, we conclude

$$\int \sqrt{4 - x^2} dx = 2 \arcsin(x/2) + (x/2) \sqrt{4 - x^2} + c$$

on any interval $I \subset (-2, 2)$.

Exercise A.6

Compute the following limits

- (a) $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{1}{x^3} \int_0^{x^2} \log(1 + \sqrt{t}) dt$, (b) $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{1}{x^4} \int_0^{x^2} (1 - \cos \sqrt{t}) dt$
- (c) $\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \left(2 \int_4^{4e} \frac{\log(kx)}{x} dx - \log(k(k+1)) \right)$,
- (d) $\lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \left(\int_1^3 \log(k(x+2)) dx - 3 \log(k+1) \right)$

Solution

(a) Setting $f(x) = \int_0^{x^2} \log(1 + \sqrt{t}) dt$, the limit takes the indeterminate form $\frac{0}{0}$ given by $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{f(x)}{x^3}$. The hypotheses of L'Hôpital's rule are satisfied, so we can move on to computing the limit

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{f'(x)}{3x^2}.$$

We compute the derivative $f'(x)$ using the Fundamental theorem of calculus and the chain rule (derivative of a composite function):

$$f'(x) = 2x \log(1 + \sqrt{x^2}) = 2x \log(1 + x), \quad x > 0.$$

In conclusion

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{1}{x^3} \int_0^{x^2} \log(1 + \sqrt{t}) dt &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{2x \log(1 + x)}{3x^2} \\ &= \frac{2}{3} \lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{\log(1 + x)}{x} = \frac{2}{3}. \end{aligned}$$

Solution

(b) Setting $f(x) = \int_0^{x^2} (1 - \cos \sqrt{t}) dt$, the limit takes the indeterminate form $\frac{0}{0}$ given by $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{f(x)}{x^4}$. The hypotheses of L'Hôpital's rule are satisfied, so we can move on to computing the limit

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{f'(x)}{4x^3}.$$

We compute the derivative $f'(x)$ using the Fundamental theorem of calculus and the chain rule (derivative of a composite function):

$$f'(x) = 2x(1 - \cos \sqrt{x^2}) = 2x(1 - \cos x), \quad x > 0.$$

In conclusion

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{1}{x^4} \int_0^{x^2} (1 - \cos \sqrt{t}) dt &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{2x(1 - \cos x)}{4x^3} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \frac{1 - \cos x}{x^2} = \frac{1}{4}. \end{aligned}$$

Solution

(c) We compute

$$\begin{aligned}
 2 \int_4^{4e} \frac{\log(kx)}{x} dx &= [\log^2(kx)]_4^{4e} = \log^2(4ke) - \log^2(4k) \\
 &= (\log(4ke) - \log(4k))(\log(4ke) + \log(4k)) \\
 &= \log \frac{4ke}{4k} \log(16k^2e) = \log(16k^2e).
 \end{aligned}$$

It follows that

$$\begin{aligned}
 \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \left(2 \int_4^{4e} \frac{\log(kx)}{x} dx - \log(k(k+1)) \right) &= \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \log(16k^2e) - \log(k(k+1)) \\
 &= \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \log \frac{16k^2e}{k^2+k} = \log(16e) = 1 + \log 16.
 \end{aligned}$$

Solution

(d) We compute

$$\begin{aligned}
 \int_1^3 \log(k(x+2)) dx &= [x \log(kx+2k)]_1^3 - \int_1^3 \frac{x}{x+2} dx \\
 &= 3 \log(5k) - \log(3k) - \int_1^3 \left(1 - \frac{2}{x+2} \right) dx \\
 &= 3 \log(5k) - \log(3k) - 2 + 2 \log \frac{5}{3}.
 \end{aligned}$$

It follows that

$$\begin{aligned}
 \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} \left(\int_1^3 \log(k(x+2)) dx - 3 \log(k+1) \right) \\
 &= \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} 3 \log(5k) - \log(3k) - 2 + 2 \log \frac{5}{3} - 3 \log(k+1) \\
 &= \lim_{k \rightarrow +\infty} 3 \log \frac{5k}{k+1} - \log(3k) - 2 + 2 \log \frac{5}{3} = -\infty.
 \end{aligned}$$

A.2 Integrals

Exercise A.7

Determine the measure (area) of the set $A \subset \mathbb{R}^2$ defined as follows:

$$A = \left\{ (x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2; -1 < x < 1, x^2 - 1 \leq y \leq \frac{x+1}{x+2} \right\}$$

Solution

We need to compute

$$\int_{-1}^1 \left(\frac{x+1}{x+2} - (x^2 - 1) \right) dx.$$

We have

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{-1}^1 \left(\frac{x+1}{x+2} + 1 - x^2 \right) dx &= \int_{-1}^1 \left(2 - \frac{1}{x+2} - x^2 \right) dx \\ &= \left[2x - \log(x+2) - \frac{x^3}{3} \right]_{-1}^1 = \frac{10}{3} - \log 3. \end{aligned}$$

Exercise A.8

Compute

$$\int_0^1 \frac{e^x + e^{x/2}}{1 + e^x} dx$$

Solution

With the substitution $y = e^{x/2}$, $x = 2 \log y$, $dx = \frac{2}{y} dy$, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^1 \frac{e^x + e^{x/2}}{1 + e^x} dx &= 2 \int_1^{\sqrt{e}} \frac{y^2 + y}{(1 + y^2)y} dy \\ &= 2 \int_1^{\sqrt{e}} \frac{y + 1}{1 + y^2} dy = [\log(y^2 + 1) + 2 \arctan y]_1^{\sqrt{e}} \\ &= \log \frac{e + 1}{2} + 2 \arctan \sqrt{e} - \frac{\pi}{2}. \end{aligned}$$

Exercise A.9

Compute

$$\int_{-\pi}^{\pi} e^{-|x|} \cos x \, dx$$

Solution

We observe that the function is even, since $f(-x) = f(x)$ for every $x \in [-\pi, \pi]$. Hence, by symmetry

$$\int_{-\pi}^{\pi} e^{-|x|} \cos x \, dx = 2 \int_0^{\pi} e^{-|x|} \cos x \, dx = 2 \int_0^{\pi} e^{-x} \cos x \, dx$$

where in the last equality we used the fact that $|x| = x$ for every $x \geq 0$. Integrating by parts twice, we have

$$\begin{aligned} I &= \int e^{-x} \cos x \, dx = e^{-x} \sin x + \int e^{-x} \sin x \, dx \\ &= e^{-x} \sin x - e^{-x} \cos x - \int e^{-x} \cos x \, dx = e^{-x} \sin x - e^{-x} \cos x - I \end{aligned}$$

from which

$$2I = e^{-x} \sin x - e^{-x} \cos x$$

and finally

$$I = \int e^{-x} \cos x \, dx = \frac{e^{-x} \sin x - e^{-x} \cos x}{2} + c$$

To compute the definite integral, we evaluate the antiderivative between 0 and π , not forgetting the factor 2 in front of the integral:

$$2[I]_0^{\pi} = e^{-\pi} + 1$$

Exercise A.10

Compute

$$\int_0^2 \frac{e^x \log(1 + e^x)}{1 + e^x} dx$$

Solution

With the substitution $1 + e^x = t$, $e^x dx = dt$, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^2 \frac{e^x \log(1 + e^x)}{1 + e^x} dx &= \int_2^{e^2+1} \frac{\log t}{t} dt \\ &= \left[\frac{\log^2 t}{2} \right]_2^{e^2+1} = \frac{1}{2} (\log^2(e^2 + 1) - \log^2 2) \end{aligned}$$

Exercise A.11

Determine whether the following integral

$$\int_0^1 \frac{\sin^3 \sqrt{x}}{e^x (1 - \cos x)} dx$$

exists and is finite.

Solution

Since the integrand is continuous on $(0, 1]$, to determine whether the given integral converges it is enough to study the behavior of f in a right neighborhood of $x = 0$. As $x \rightarrow 0^+$ we have

$$f(x) \sim \frac{(\sqrt{x})^3}{\frac{1}{2}x^2} = \frac{x^{3/2}}{\frac{1}{2}x^2} = 2 \frac{1}{x^{1/2}}$$

Since $1/2 < 1$, by the limit comparison test the given integral exists and is finite; more formally, the function $f(x)$ is improperly integrable in a right neighborhood of the origin.

Exercise A.12

Determine whether the following integral

$$\int_0^{+\infty} \frac{x^2}{(3 + 5x^5) \arctan x^{3/2}} dx$$

exists and is finite.

Solution

The integrand is continuous on $(0, +\infty)$. To determine whether the given integral converges we need to study the behavior of the integrand in a right neighborhood of $x = 0$, where the denominator is not defined, and in a neighborhood of $+\infty$. It is convenient to rewrite this integral of the third kind as

$$\int_0^1 \frac{x^2}{(3 + 5x^5) \arctan x^{3/2}} dx + \int_1^{+\infty} \frac{x^2}{(3 + 5x^5) \arctan x^{3/2}} dx$$

in order to highlight the two separate analyses to be carried out. As $x \rightarrow 0^+$ we have

$$f(x) \sim \frac{x^2}{3x^{3/2}} = \frac{1}{3x^{-1/2}}$$

Since $-1/2 < 1$, by the limit comparison test the function $f(x)$ is improperly integrable in a right neighborhood of the origin. Let us now verify that it is also improperly integrable in a neighborhood of $+\infty$. As $x \rightarrow +\infty$ we have

$$f(x) \sim \frac{x^2}{5x^{5\frac{\pi}{2}}} = \frac{2}{5\pi} \frac{1}{x^3}$$

Since $3 > 1$, by the limit comparison test the function $f(x)$ is improperly integrable also in a neighborhood of $+\infty$. Overall, therefore, the improper integral exists and is finite. We observe that, in fact, since $f(x) \sim \frac{\sqrt{x}}{3}$ as $x \rightarrow 0^+$, the function can be extended by continuity at $x = 0$ and we can set, by definition, $f(0) = 0$.

Exercise A.13

Determine for which values of the parameter $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ the following improper integral

$$\int_0^1 \frac{\log(1+x^2)}{x^\alpha(1+x^3)} dx$$

exists and is finite.

Solution

The integrand is continuous on $(0, 1)$. To determine for which values of $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ the given integral converges it is enough to study the behavior of the integrand in a right neighborhood of $x = 0$, where the denominator is not defined. As $x \rightarrow 0^+$ we have

$$f(x) \sim \frac{x^2}{x^\alpha} = \frac{1}{x^{\alpha-2}}$$

which is improperly integrable for $\alpha - 2 < 1$, i.e., for $\alpha < 3$.

Exercise A.14

Given the following improper integral

$$\int_1^{+\infty} \frac{x \arctan(x^2) \log^\alpha\left(1 + \frac{1}{x}\right)}{x^4 + 1} dx$$

study its convergence as $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ varies. Then, for $\alpha = 0$, compute it using the definition.

Solution

The integrand is continuous on $[1, +\infty)$. To determine for which values of $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ the given integral converges it is enough to study the behavior of the integrand in a neighborhood of $+\infty$. As $x \rightarrow +\infty$ we have

$$f(x) \sim \frac{x}{x^4} \frac{\pi}{2} \left(\frac{1}{x}\right)^\alpha = \frac{\pi}{2} \frac{1}{x^{\alpha+3}}$$

where we needed the asymptotic estimates $x^4 + 1 \sim x^4$, $\log^\alpha\left(1 + \frac{1}{x}\right) \sim \left(\frac{1}{x}\right)^\alpha$, $x \rightarrow +\infty$. By the limit comparison test, the improper integral exists and is finite if $\alpha + 3 > 1$, that is, $\alpha > -2$.

For $\alpha = 0$, the integral becomes

$$\int_1^{+\infty} \frac{x \arctan(x^2)}{x^4 + 1} dx$$

We can proceed by substitution, setting $\arctan(x^2) = t$, $\frac{x}{1+x^4} dx = \frac{1}{2} dt$, and we obtain

$$\int_1^{+\infty} \frac{x \arctan(x^2)}{x^4 + 1} dx = \int_{\pi/4}^{\pi/2} \frac{t}{2} dt = \frac{3}{64} \pi^2$$

Exercise A.15

After determining whether or not the function is summable, compute the following integrals

$$(a) \int_{-1}^0 \frac{1}{(1-x)\sqrt{1+x}} dx, \quad (b) \int_{-1}^1 \frac{1}{(1-x)\sqrt{1+x}} dx, \quad (c) \int_0^{+\infty} x e^{-x^2} dx$$

$$(d) \int_0^{+\infty} x^3 e^{-x^2} dx, \quad (e) \int_4^{+\infty} \frac{1}{x(x-3)} dx$$

These are all continuous and positive functions on their respective intervals of integration, hence they are all integrable functions. Each integral represents the measure of the region under the graph. In all cases, the region under the graph is an unbounded subset of the plane, so the integral is either a positive number or $+\infty$. Recall that a function is called summable when it is integrable with finite integral.

Solution

(a) The function

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{(1-x)\sqrt{1+x}}$$

is continuous on the interval $(-1, 0]$. Hence, we need to study its behavior in a right neighborhood of $x = -1$. As $x \rightarrow -1^+$ we have

$$f(x) \sim \frac{1}{\sqrt{1+x}} = \frac{1}{(1+x)^{\frac{1}{2}}}, \quad x \rightarrow -1^+$$

hence the function is summable on $(-1, 0]$ by the comparison test, since $\frac{1}{2} < 1$. This means that

$$\int_{-1}^0 f(x) dx = \lim_{\varepsilon \rightarrow 0^+} \int_{-1+\varepsilon}^0 f(x) dx$$

and that this limit exists, finite and positive.

Setting $y = \sqrt{1+x}$, $x = y^2 - 1$, $dx = 2y dy$, we obtain

$$\int_{-1+\varepsilon}^0 f(x) dx = \int_{\sqrt{\varepsilon}}^1 \frac{2}{2-y^2} dy,$$

hence, taking into account that $\sqrt{\varepsilon} \rightarrow 0$ as $\varepsilon \rightarrow 0$, we have

$$\int_{-1}^0 f(x) dx = \lim_{\delta \rightarrow 0^+} \int_{\delta}^1 \frac{2}{2-y^2} dy = \int_0^1 \frac{2}{2-y^2} dy.$$

Note that, in this case, after the change of variable, we obtained the integral of a bounded function starting from the integral of an unbounded one.

Using partial fractions, and taking into account also that $|y - \sqrt{2}| = \sqrt{2} - y$ on the interval of integration, we have

$$\frac{2}{2-y^2} = -\frac{2}{(y-\sqrt{2})(y+\sqrt{2})} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \left(\frac{1}{y+\sqrt{2}} - \frac{1}{y-\sqrt{2}} \right),$$

hence

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{-1}^0 f(x)dx &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \int_0^1 \left(\frac{1}{y+\sqrt{2}} - \frac{1}{y-\sqrt{2}} \right) dy \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \left[\log \frac{y+\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{2}-y} \right]_0^1 = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \log \frac{1+\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{2}-1}.\end{aligned}$$

Solution

(b) We have

$$\int_{-1}^1 \frac{1}{(1-x)\sqrt{1+x}} dx = \int_{-1}^0 \frac{1}{(1-x)\sqrt{1+x}} dx + \int_0^1 \frac{1}{(1-x)\sqrt{1+x}} dx$$

where the first integral is finite and was computed in the previous item. The integral now given is therefore finite if and only if so is

$$\int_0^1 \frac{1}{(1-x)\sqrt{1+x}} dx.$$

The function

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{(1-x)\sqrt{1+x}}$$

is continuous and bounded on every interval $[0, 1-\varepsilon]$, $\varepsilon > 0$. Moreover, we have

$$f(x) \sim \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \frac{1}{1-x}, \quad x \rightarrow 1^-$$

hence the function is not summable on $[0, 1)$ by the comparison test. This means that

$$\int_0^1 f(x)dx = \lim_{\varepsilon \rightarrow 0^+} \int_0^{1-\varepsilon} f(x)dx = +\infty,$$

hence the given integral is also

$$\int_{-1}^1 \frac{1}{(1-x)\sqrt{1+x}} dx = +\infty.$$

Solution

(c) The function $f(x) = xe^{-x^2}$ is continuous and bounded on every interval $[0, a]$ with $a > 0$. Moreover, we have

$$f(x) = O\left(\frac{1}{x^\alpha}\right), \quad x \rightarrow +\infty,$$

for any $\alpha > 0$; in particular, choosing $\alpha > 1$, the function is summable on $[0, +\infty)$. This means that

$$\int_0^{+\infty} f(x)dx = \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \int_0^a f(x)dx$$

and that this limit exists, finite and positive. Indeed

$$\lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \int_0^a x e^{-x^2} dx = -\frac{1}{2} \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} [e^{-x^2}]_0^a = -\frac{1}{2} \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} (e^{-a^2} - 1) = \frac{1}{2}.$$

The given integral is equal to $1/2$.

Solution

(d) The function $f(x) = x^3 e^{-x^2}$ is continuous and bounded on every interval $[0, a]$ with $a > 0$. Moreover, we have

$$f(x) = O\left(\frac{1}{x^\alpha}\right), \quad x \rightarrow +\infty,$$

for any $\alpha > 0$; in particular, choosing $\alpha > 1$, the function is summable on $[0, +\infty)$. This means that

$$\int_0^{+\infty} f(x) dx = \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \int_0^a f(x) dx$$

and that this limit exists, finite and positive. Indeed, integrating by parts, and taking into account the integral computed in the previous item,

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \int_0^a x^3 e^{-x^2} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \left\{ -\frac{1}{2} [x^2 e^{-x^2}]_0^a + \int_0^a x e^{-x^2} dx \right\} \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \left(-\frac{1}{2} a^2 e^{-a^2} + \int_0^a x e^{-x^2} dx \right) = \frac{1}{2}. \end{aligned}$$

The given integral is equal to $1/2$.

Solution

(e) The function $f(x) = \frac{1}{x(x-3)}$ is continuous and bounded on every interval $[4, a]$ with $a > 4$. Moreover, we have

$$f(x) \sim \frac{1}{x^2}, \quad x \rightarrow +\infty,$$

hence the function is summable on $[4, +\infty)$ by comparison. This means that

$$\int_4^{+\infty} f(x) dx = \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \int_4^a f(x) dx$$

and that this limit exists, finite and positive. Indeed, using partial fractions,

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \int_4^a \frac{1}{x(x-3)} dx &= \frac{1}{3} \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \int_4^a \left(\frac{1}{x-3} - \frac{1}{x} \right) dx = \frac{1}{3} \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \left[\log \frac{x-3}{x} \right]_4^a \\ &= \frac{1}{3} \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \left(\log \frac{a-3}{a} - \log \frac{1}{4} \right) = -\frac{1}{3} \log \frac{1}{4} = \frac{1}{3} \log 4. \end{aligned}$$

The given integral is equal to $\frac{1}{3} \log 4$.

Exercise A.16

Determine all $\alpha \geq 0$ for which the function

$$f(x) = (\sqrt{1+x} - \sqrt{x})^\alpha$$

is summable on $[0, +\infty)$

Solution

The function $f(x)$ is continuous and positive on $[0, +\infty)$, so it is enough to analyze its behavior in a neighborhood of $+\infty$, that is, as $x \rightarrow +\infty$. Multiplying and dividing by $(\sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{x})^\alpha$, we have

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{(\sqrt{1+x} + \sqrt{x})^\alpha} \sim \frac{1}{(2\sqrt{x})^\alpha} = \frac{1}{2^\alpha} \frac{1}{x^{\alpha/2}}, \quad x \rightarrow +\infty.$$

By comparison, it follows that f is summable on $[0, +\infty)$ if and only if $\alpha/2 > 1$, hence if and only if

$$\alpha > 2.$$

Exercise A.17

Given

$$\int_0^{+\infty} \frac{\log(1 + e^{x^2})}{2 + 3x^{5/2} + x^{3\alpha} + 12x} dx$$

determine for which values of $\alpha > 0$ it converges, that is, it exists and is finite.

Solution

The function $f(x)$ is continuous and positive on $[0, +\infty)$, so it is enough to analyze its behavior in a neighborhood of $+\infty$, that is, as $x \rightarrow +\infty$. We have

$$f(x) = \frac{\log(1 + e^{x^2})}{2 + 3x^{5/2} + x^{3\alpha} + 12x} \sim \frac{\log(e^{x^2})}{3x^{5/2} + x^{3\alpha}} = \frac{x^2}{3x^{5/2} + x^{3\alpha}} \sim$$

$$\sim \begin{cases} \frac{x^2}{3x^{5/2}} = \frac{1}{3} \frac{1}{x^{1/2}} & \text{if } 3\alpha < 5/2, \text{ i.e., if and only if } \alpha < 5/6 \\ \frac{x^2}{4x^{5/2}} = \frac{1}{4} \frac{1}{x^{1/2}} & \text{if } 3\alpha = 5/2, \text{ i.e., if and only if } \alpha = 5/6 \\ \frac{x^2}{x^{3\alpha}} = \frac{1}{x^{3\alpha-2}} & \text{if } 3\alpha > 5/2, \text{ i.e., if and only if } \alpha > 5/6 \end{cases}$$

In the first two cases, the improper integral diverges by limit comparison, since $1/2 < 1$. In the third case, instead, it exists and is finite if and only if $3\alpha - 2 > 1$, that is, if and only if $\alpha > 1$. In conclusion, the improper integral exists and is finite (converges) for $\alpha > 1$, and diverges for $\alpha \leq 1$.

Exercise A.18

Given

$$\int_0^{+\infty} \frac{3 + 2x^{3/2} + 5x^{4\alpha} + x^{1/2}}{\log(1 + e^{x^5})} dx$$

determine for which values of $\alpha > 0$ it converges, that is, it exists and is finite.

Solution

The function $f(x)$ is continuous and positive on $[0, +\infty)$, so it is enough to analyze its behavior in a neighborhood of $+\infty$, that is, as $x \rightarrow +\infty$. We have

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) &= \frac{3 + 2x^{3/2} + 5x^{4\alpha} + x^{1/2}}{\log(1 + e^{x^5})} \sim \frac{2x^{3/2} + 5x^{4\alpha}}{\log(e^{x^5})} = \frac{2x^{3/2} + 5x^{4\alpha}}{x^5} \sim \\ &\sim \begin{cases} \frac{2x^{3/2}}{x^5} = 2\frac{1}{x^{7/2}} & \text{if } 4\alpha < 3/2, \text{ i.e., if and only if } \alpha < 3/8 \\ \frac{7x^{3/2}}{x^5} = 7\frac{1}{x^{7/2}} & \text{if } 4\alpha = 3/2, \text{ i.e., if and only if } \alpha = 3/8 \\ \frac{5x^{4\alpha}}{x^5} = 5\frac{1}{x^{5-4\alpha}} & \text{if } 4\alpha > 3/2, \text{ i.e., if and only if } \alpha > 3/8 \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

In the first two cases, the improper integral converges by limit comparison, since $7/2 > 1$. In the third case, instead, it exists and is finite if and only if $5 - 4\alpha > 1$, that is, if and only if $\alpha < 1$. In conclusion, the improper integral exists and is finite (converges) for $\alpha < 1$, and diverges for $\alpha \geq 1$.

Exercise A.19

Given

$$\int_1^{+\infty} \frac{\arctan x}{\sqrt{x}(1 + x^\alpha)} dx$$

determine for which values of $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ it converges, that is, it exists and is finite.

Solution

The function $f(x)$ is continuous and positive on $[1, +\infty)$, so it is enough to analyze its behavior in a neighborhood of $+\infty$, that is, as $x \rightarrow +\infty$. We have

$$f(x) \sim \begin{cases} \frac{\pi/2}{x^{1/2} + x^{1/2+\alpha}} \sim \frac{\pi}{2x^{1/2}} & \text{if } \alpha < 0 \\ \frac{\pi/2}{2x^{1/2}} = \frac{\pi}{4x^{1/2}} & \text{if } \alpha = 0 \\ \frac{\pi/2}{x^{1/2} + x^{1/2+\alpha}} \sim \frac{\pi}{2x^{1/2+\alpha}} & \text{if } \alpha > 0 \end{cases}$$

In the first two cases, the improper integral diverges by limit comparison, since $1/2 < 1$. In the third case, instead, it exists and is finite if and only if $\frac{1}{2} + \alpha > 1$, that is, if and only if $\alpha > \frac{1}{2}$. In conclusion, the improper integral exists and is finite (converges) in a neighborhood $U(+\infty)$ for $\alpha > \frac{1}{2}$, and diverges for $\alpha \leq \frac{1}{2}$.

Exercise A.20

Perform the change of variable $y = \sqrt{x}$ in

$$\int_4^{+\infty} \frac{1}{\sqrt{x}(\sqrt{x}+2)(\sqrt{x}+6)} dx$$

and write the corresponding integral in dy . Then determine the value of the integral.

Solution

From $y = \sqrt{x}$, $x = y^2$, $dx = 2y \, dy$, we obtain

$$\int_4^{+\infty} \frac{1}{\sqrt{x}(\sqrt{x}+2)(\sqrt{x}+6)} dx = \int_2^{+\infty} \frac{2}{(y+2)(y+6)} dy.$$

Using partial fractions,

$$\begin{aligned} \int_2^{+\infty} \frac{2}{(y+2)(y+6)} dy &= \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \int_2^a \frac{2}{(y+2)(y+6)} dy \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \int_2^a \left(\frac{1}{y+2} - \frac{1}{y+6} \right) dy = \frac{1}{2} \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \left[\log \frac{y+2}{y+6} \right]_2^a \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \left(\log \frac{a+2}{a+6} - \log \frac{1}{2} \right) = -\frac{1}{2} \log \frac{1}{2} = \frac{1}{2} \log 2. \end{aligned}$$

Exercise A.21

Given the function

$$f : [1, +\infty) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, \quad f(x) = \int_1^x \frac{(t^3 - 27)(t - 1)^3}{t^7 + 1} dt$$

- Write $f'(x)$.
- Find the possible relative maximum or minimum points in the interior of the domain, specifying the sign of the values taken at those points.
- State whether $\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} f(x)$ exists and whether it is finite or not, justifying your answer.
- Determine for which value of α the limit

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} (x - 1)^\alpha f(x)$$

is finite and different from 0, justifying your answer.

Solution

By the Fundamental theorem of calculus

$$f'(x) = \frac{(x^3 - 27)(x - 1)^3}{x^7 + 1}.$$

Solution

The first derivative vanishes at the endpoint $x = 1$ of the domain and at the interior point $x = 3$. It is negative for $1 < x < 3$ and positive for $x > 3$. The point $x = 3$ is an interior (absolute) minimum point. The corresponding value

$$f(3) = \int_1^3 \frac{(t^3 - 27)(t - 1)^3}{t^7 + 1} dt$$

is negative, as follows from the fact that $f(1) = 0$ and that f is strictly decreasing on $[1, 3]$. The same conclusion is reached directly by observing that the integrand is negative on the interval $[1, 3]$.

Solution

The function f is strictly increasing on $(3, +\infty)$, hence the limit exists, finite or $+\infty$. By definition,

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} f(x) = \int_1^{+\infty} \frac{(t^3 - 27)(t - 1)^3}{t^7 + 1} dt,$$

hence the question is equivalent to asking whether or not the function

$$g(t) = \frac{(t^3 - 27)(t - 1)^3}{t^7 + 1}$$

is summable on $[1, +\infty)$.

The function $g(t)$ is continuous on $[1, +\infty)$, so it is enough to examine its behavior as $t \rightarrow +\infty$. We have

$$g(t) \sim \frac{1}{t}, \quad t \rightarrow +\infty,$$

from which the function is not summable on $[1, +\infty)$.

In conclusion, $\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} f(x) = +\infty$.

Solution

We have $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} f(x) = f(1) = 0$, hence for $\alpha \geq 0$ the given limit is zero. For $\alpha < 0$, say $\alpha = -\beta$ with $\beta > 0$, the given limit

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 1^+} \frac{f(x)}{(x - 1)^\beta}$$

has the indeterminate form $\frac{0}{0}$. Applying L'Hôpital's rule, we have

$$\begin{aligned}\lim_{x \rightarrow 1^+} \frac{f(x)}{(x-1)^\beta} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 1^+} \frac{f'(x)}{\beta(x-1)^{\beta-1}} \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 1^+} \frac{(x^3 - 27)(x-1)^3}{\beta(x-1)^{\beta-1}(x^7 + 1)} = -\frac{13}{\beta} \lim_{x \rightarrow 1^+} \frac{(x-1)^3}{(x-1)^{\beta-1}}.\end{aligned}$$

This limit exists for every $\beta > 0$, but it is finite and different from zero, as required, if and only if $\beta = 4$ (and in this case it equals $-13/4$).

In conclusion, the given limit exists, finite and different from zero, if and only if $\alpha = -4$.

Exercise A.22

Compute

$$\int_0^{+\infty} \frac{1}{\sqrt{x}(\sqrt{x}+1)(\sqrt{x}+4)} dx$$

Then explain how one can anticipate, without using antiderivatives, the summability of the function on the given interval.

Solution

The function

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{x}(\sqrt{x}+1)(\sqrt{x}+4)}$$

is continuous and positive on $(0, +\infty)$, unbounded as $x \rightarrow 0$, and the interval of integration is unbounded. Writing

$$\int_0^{+\infty} f(x) dx = \int_0^1 f(x) dx + \int_1^{+\infty} f(x) dx,$$

it is necessary and sufficient to examine the asymptotic behavior of $f(x)$ as $x \rightarrow 0$ and as $x \rightarrow +\infty$. We have

$$f(x) \sim \frac{1}{4} \frac{1}{\sqrt{x}}, \quad x \rightarrow 0; \quad f(x) \sim \frac{1}{x^{3/2}}, \quad x \rightarrow +\infty.$$

Therefore, $f(x)$ is summable on $(0, +\infty)$ because, by comparison, it is summable both on $(0, 1]$ and on $[1, +\infty)$.

We can compute the value with the substitution $y = \sqrt{x}$, $x = y^2$, $dx = 2y dy$:

$$\begin{aligned}\int_0^{+\infty} \frac{1}{\sqrt{x}(\sqrt{x}+1)(\sqrt{x}+4)} dx &= \int_0^{+\infty} \frac{2}{(y+1)(y+4)} dy \\ &= \frac{2}{3} \int_0^{+\infty} \left(\frac{1}{y+1} - \frac{1}{y+4} \right) dy = \frac{2}{3} \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \left[\log \frac{y+1}{y+4} \right]_0^a \\ &= \frac{2}{3} \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \left(\log \frac{a+1}{a+4} - \log \frac{1}{4} \right) = -\frac{2}{3} \log \frac{1}{4} = \frac{2}{3} \log 4.\end{aligned}$$

Exercise A.23

Let

$$f : [1/2, +\infty[\longrightarrow \mathbb{R}, \quad f(x) = \int_1^x \frac{\log t}{t^2} dt$$

- Determine the possible local extremum points and the monotonicity of f .
- Justify the existence of a horizontal asymptote for f .
- Compute $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{f(x)}{(x-1)^2}$.

Solution

By the Fundamental theorem of calculus,

$$f'(x) = \frac{\log x}{x^2}$$

for every x in the given domain $[1/2, +\infty)$. The derivative vanishes at $x = 1$, is negative for $1/2 \leq x < 1$ and positive for $x > 1$. The function f is therefore strictly decreasing on $[1/2, 1)$ and strictly increasing on $(1, +\infty)$. The point $x = 1$ is an absolute minimum point with value $f(1) = 0$; in particular the function takes only non-negative values (positive for every $x \neq 1$ in the given domain).

Solution

We have to justify that $\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} f(x)$ exists and is finite. By definition,

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} f(x) = \int_1^{+\infty} \frac{\log t}{t^2} dt,$$

hence we have to justify the fact that the function

$$g(t) = \frac{\log t}{t^2}$$

is summable on $[1, +\infty)$.

The function $g(t)$ is continuous on $[1, +\infty)$, so it is enough to examine its behavior as $t \rightarrow +\infty$. Since $\log t$ is an infinity of lower order than any power, we have

$$g(t) = O\left(\frac{1}{t^{2-\varepsilon}}\right), \quad t \rightarrow +\infty,$$

for every $\varepsilon > 0$, from which, choosing ε such that $2 - \varepsilon > 1$, the function g is summable on $[1, +\infty)$.

Solution

We have $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} f(x) = f(1) = 0$, hence the given limit has the indeterminate form $\frac{0}{0}$. Applying L'Hôpital's rule, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{f(x)}{(x-1)^2} &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{f'(x)}{2(x-1)} \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{\log x}{2(x-1)x^2} = \frac{1}{2} \lim_{x \rightarrow 1} \frac{\log x}{x-1} = \frac{1}{2} \lim_{y \rightarrow 0} \frac{\log(1+y)}{y} = \frac{1}{2}. \end{aligned}$$

Exercise A.24

Consider

$$\int_2^{+\infty} \frac{x+2}{x(x+1)(x-1)} dx.$$

Before computing it, justify the fact that this integral exists and is finite.

Solution

The function

$$f(x) = \frac{x+2}{x(x+1)(x-1)}$$

is continuous and positive on $[2, +\infty)$ and has the asymptotic behavior

$$f(x) \sim \frac{1}{x^2}, \quad x \rightarrow +\infty,$$

hence it is improperly integrable in a neighborhood of $+\infty$ by comparison.

From the partial fractions

$$\frac{x+2}{x(x+1)(x-1)} = -\frac{2}{x} + \frac{1}{2} \frac{1}{x+1} + \frac{3}{2} \frac{1}{x-1},$$

we obtain the antiderivative on $[2, +\infty)$

$$\int \frac{x+2}{x(x+1)(x-1)} dx = \log \frac{(x+1)^{1/2}(x-1)^{3/2}}{x^2}.$$

Hence

$$\begin{aligned} \int_2^{+\infty} \frac{x+2}{x(x+1)(x-1)} dx &= \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \left[\log \frac{(x+1)^{1/2}(x-1)^{3/2}}{x^2} \right]_2^a \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \left(\log \frac{(a+1)^{1/2}(a-1)^{3/2}}{a^2} - \log \frac{3^{1/2}}{4} \right) = \log \frac{4}{\sqrt{3}}. \end{aligned}$$

Exercise A.25

Using the change of variable $y = e^x$, compute

$$\int_0^{+\infty} \frac{e^x}{(e^x + 2)(e^x + 3)} dx.$$

Solution

From $y = e^x$, $x = \log y$, $dx = \frac{1}{y} dy$ and using partial fractions, it follows that

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^{+\infty} \frac{e^x}{(e^x + 2)(e^x + 3)} dx &= \int_1^{+\infty} \frac{1}{(y + 2)(y + 3)} dy \\ &= \int_1^{+\infty} \left(\frac{1}{y + 2} - \frac{1}{y + 3} \right) dy = \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \left[\log \frac{y + 2}{y + 3} \right]_1^a \\ &= \lim_{a \rightarrow +\infty} \left(\log \frac{a + 2}{a + 3} - \log \frac{3}{4} \right) = \log \frac{4}{3} \end{aligned}$$

Exercise A.26

Given the function

$$f : [1, +\infty) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, \quad f(x) = \int_1^x \frac{t^3 - 27}{t^5 + 1} dt$$

- Write $f'(x)$.
- Determine the possible relative maximum or minimum points.
- Write $f''(x)$.
- To justify the presence or absence of inflection points, carry out separately a brief study of the polynomial function $y = -2x^5 + 135x^2 + 3$, sketching a qualitative graph. This polynomial is one of the factors of $f''(x)$.
- Based on the previous item, state whether f has inflection points. (You are not asked to find these points explicitly, but only to state whether there are any, how many there are, and to locate them with respect to other notable points such as relative maximum or minimum points).
- State whether $\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} f(x)$ exists and whether it is finite or not, justifying your answer (if it is finite, you are not asked to compute it).

Solution

By the Fundamental theorem of calculus,

$$f'(x) = \frac{x^3 - 27}{x^5 + 1}$$

for all x in the given domain $[1, +\infty)$.

Solution

The derivative vanishes at $x = 3$, is negative on $[1, 3)$ and positive on $(3, +\infty)$. The function is strictly decreasing on $[1, 3)$ and strictly increasing on $(3, +\infty)$. The point $x = 3$ is an absolute minimum point, with value

$$f(3) = \int_1^3 \frac{t^3 - 27}{t^5 + 1} dt,$$

which can be computed using partial fractions if necessary, and which is negative since $f(1) = 0$ and f is strictly decreasing on $[1, 3)$. The sign of $f(3)$ can also be determined directly by observing that the integrand is strictly negative for $t \in [1, 3)$.

Solution

$$f''(x) = \frac{x^2(-2x^5 + 135x^2 + 3)}{(x^5 + 1)^2}.$$

Solution

We have $\lim_{x \rightarrow \pm\infty} y(x) = \mp\infty$. Then $y'(x) = -10x(x^3 - 27)$, from which $y(x)$ is strictly decreasing on $(-\infty, 0)$, the point $x = 0$ is a relative minimum point with value $y(0) = 3$, $y(x)$ is strictly increasing on $(0, 3)$, the point $x = 3$ is a relative maximum point with value $y(3) = 732$, and $y(x)$ is strictly decreasing on $(3, +\infty)$. In particular, $y(x)$ has a unique zero at $x = \alpha$ with $\alpha \in (3, +\infty)$, $y(x) > 0$ for $x < \alpha$, $y(x) < 0$ for $x > \alpha$.

Solution

On the given domain, the second derivative has the same sign as $-2x^5 + 135x^2 + 3$. By what we saw in the previous item, the function f has an inflection point at $x = \alpha$, with $\alpha \in (3, +\infty)$, is strictly convex on $(1, \alpha)$ and strictly concave on $(\alpha, +\infty)$.

Solution

The function is strictly increasing on $(3, +\infty)$, hence the limit exists, finite or $+\infty$.

By definition,

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} f(x) = \int_1^{+\infty} \frac{t^3 - 27}{t^5 + 1} dt,$$

hence the question is equivalent to asking whether or not the function

$$g(t) = \frac{t^3 - 27}{t^5 + 1}$$

is summable on $[1, +\infty)$.

The function $g(t)$ is continuous on $[1, +\infty)$, so it is enough to examine its behavior as $t \rightarrow +\infty$. We have

$$g(t) \sim \frac{1}{t^2}, \quad t \rightarrow +\infty,$$

from which the function is summable on $[1, +\infty)$.

In conclusion, $\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} f(x)$ exists and is finite. If necessary, it can be computed using partial fractions.